teach me to love (again)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/32175964.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Rape/Non-Con

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
not depicted just mentioned, Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra & Entrapta & Scorpia (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Finn | Adora/Catra Child (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), pretty much everyone i'm just too lazy to tag them all

Additional Tags:
Single Parents, mom!Catra, teacher!adora, Canon Lesbian Relationship, Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Slow Burn, Eventual Romance, Eventual Smut, Childhood Friends, Friends to Lovers, Enemies to Friends to Lovers

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by femmetastrophe

Summary

Catra is a single mother, barely scraping by. She loves Finn with her whole heart, but she always feels like a part of her heart is missing.

Adora is a teacher, the sweetest and most patient woman you'll ever meet. Her life would be perfect, if only a ghost from her past would stop haunting her.

When their paths cross after 10 years, could life be anything but perfect? Inner demons and insecurities give these two a run for their money, but with them, nothing could ever keep them apart.

Notes

updates one or twice a week, Ihave a few other wips Ineed to finish. enjoy!

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paths cross

"Glimmer , Iknow this is really important but so is the first day of school. Ireally can't be late, Im the teacher ,"Adora complains, desperately trying to end her call with Glimmer.

"Adora! Im serious! Y ou've met my mom, you know how scary she is!"Glimmer exclaims through the screen. Adora continues putting her hair up, placing a few bobby pins in place to hold back her grown-out bangs.

"No, Idon't. Y our mom is very nice and Im sure you have nothing to worry about. Now seriously, Ihave to go to work,"Adora replies, hair finally in place. Glimmer simply groans at that.

"Y eah yeah, go shape young minds or whatever. Im just going to go panic by myself."She dismissed , a wave of her hand the signal of surrender. Adora rolled her eyes with a fond smile.

"Go call Bow about it. Bye Glimmer , good luck,"Adora said, hanging up her video chat with a wave. Glimmer had just spent the past hour ranting to her about her mom wanting her to take an interest in the family business and start learning how to run it. Apparently that was a bad thing and also somehow Adora's problem.

With that dilemma taken care of, Adora grabbed her coffee tumbler, iced instead of hot like the other teachers, and her keys. Throwing them in her work tote, she walked out the door with her arms full of her work supplies.

Today was the first day of the new school year. As a third grade teacher, her job was to make these kids excited about learning. That meant being welcoming, fun, and most importantly, prepared. The last part Adora had always been especially good at.

Once having arrived at Brightmoon Elementary, Adora unlocked her classroom and set her bags and coffee down at her desk. The room was decorated in mostly white and gold, an homage to a childhood memory, but also a whimsical setting for young children.

Adoras booted her laptop, finished placing nametags, and added any last-minute touches to her classroom. Deeming herself class-ready, she walked to the school lobby to wait for incoming students.

~

"Morning baby, come on, we've got to get up," Catra cooed, leaning over Finn's bed. Their eyes slowly blinked open and they gave a small groan. Catra giggled at their dramatics. "You don't want to be late on your first day! Let's start the day," Catra continued, her voice sweet. Finn stretched their limbs, a loud yawn accompanying the crack of their joints. Catra laughed at their adorable morning antics.

"Do I have to go?" Finn complained to their mother. Catra shook her head with a fond expression.

"Yes. Now come on. I'll make you oatmeal if you can get dressed by yourself," Catra replied, tussling her kid's hair. Finn's ears perked forward with interest at the mention of food. It reminded her of someone she once knew.

With a smile, Catra walked from Finn's room to the kitchen, intending to make good on her promise of oatmeal. She could distantly hear Finn moving around in their room, pulling open drawers and rummaging through them.

Catra never thought her future would end up like this. A single mother, a dead end job, and still the happiest she'd been in a long time. She may have missed out on a lot of normal life, but she didn't mind when she got to give someone else the life she never had.

Finn emerged from their room, having dressed themself in the outfit Catra had set out for them last night. The two ate breakfast at the

small table in the kitchen, Catra listening to Finn babble about how excited they were to meet their teacher while they drew something on a scrap piece of paper with a singke crayon. Apparently they had heard she was really nice, fun, and to top it all off, pretty. Catra snorted a bit at that part. She didn't think she'd ever heard someone compliment their teacher so much, but maybe that just spoke to how great this particular one was.

"Alrighty kiddo, let's get moving. We don't want to keep Ms. Grayskull waiting," Catra encouraged, gathering their bowls and placing them in the sink. Finn frowned at having to put their drawing away, but went to grab their backpack. After writing the teacher a note and making sure Finn had everything they needed, Catra dropped them off at school. She kissed him on the head and wished him good luck before driving to work.

~

Adora gathered a line of new students out in the lobby, greeting each one with a smile and a welcome. Once she was sure she had all the students she was meant, she led them back to her classroom. Ushering in her new students, she watched them find their marked seats.

One of the children stopped in front of her when they walked in, reaching in their backpack for something. Adora looked at them with confusion until the student handed her a note, written on clean, yellow toned paper. She took it with an assuring smile and reminded the kid to go find the desk with their name on it.

She opened the note, curious to see what was so urgent for the first day.

Finn's mom here, hello. Finn uses they/them pronouns. I know it doesn't say that on the computer so I'm just telling you here :)

Adora smiled at the note. What a good mom, making sure their kid is comfortable at school. The handwriting looked oddly familiar, but

then again, she had seen a lot of handwriting in her few years of teaching.

She began their class with introductions, hopefully helping the students make new friends. She instructed projects on her student's families, interests, and personalities and had them share with the class. The day passed in peace and excitement, kids getting excited for school and getting to know their teacher.

The end of the day came quickly , the first day was often the easiest. Students left, some on the bus and some in their parent's cars, but one student remained. The little magicat kid she came to know as Finn. A sweet kid, but a rambunctious and energetic one too. It reminded her of someone from when she was that age. About 20 minutes from the school ray's end, a car rolled up to the pick-up area, and Finn's ears turned towards the car. Their tail waving in excitement, they waited with bated breath as a figure stepped out of the car. Finn's mother, Adora would assume.

But it wasn't the mother's lateness that struck Adora. She looked so familiar. Like someone Adora thought she'd never see again. She was stunned, and stood in shocked silence as the figure approached Finn and began to bend a bit to get closer to their level. She pushed her hair aside and Adora caught a glimpse of her face.

~

Catra arrived at work, just barely on time. After not being able to finish college while dealing with the struggles of being a single teenage mom, she found a job as a marketing associate for a nonprofit. She didn't do much in the way of actually helping the people her organization served, but she did spread the message and that was about as close as she was going to get.

The day was full of long meetings, making graphics, and endless hours in front of a computer screen. The day was relatively slow until her last meeting of the day, right before she could leave. She

anxiously checked her watch as the meeting drawled on. At this point, she would be late to pick up Finn.

As her meeting ended, she ran back to her desk and quickly grabbed all of her items and left, not bothering to say goodbye to her coworkers. Going at exactly the speed limit, Catra made it to the school only 15 minutes late. She rushed to get out of the car, shutting the door a bit too hard behind her. She never took the time to look at the woman waiting with her kid, too busy trying to not seem like a bad mom. Jogging in her low heels, Catra made it to Finn, crouching down and getting the hair out of her face to talk to them.

~

"Hey kiddo, ready to go home? Sorry about that, I ran into some trouble leaving work and-" Catra is interrupted by a sob coming from the woman before her. Her ears flick back towards their source. That sob sounded awfully familiar...

"Catra?" Adora whispered, emotion overpowering her words. Catra's head snapped up, eyes immediately catching the blue ones in front of her. Tears welled in her eyes.

"Adora? Adora!" Catra exclaimed as she surges forward to cling to Adora. They embrace, desperately holding on to each other for support as they silently cry. They are interrupted by young Finn.

"Mama, why are you crying?" They asked, curiosity and confusion in their tone. Catra wiped her eyes and kneeled down to eye level with Finn.

"Ms. Grayskull is a very old friend of mine. I haven't seen her in a long time. I'm crying because I'm happy ," Catra explained, her voice still shaky. Finn still looks confused but lets the issue rest.

Catra stood up again, attempting to regain her composure. She looked Adora in the eye and smiled. Grabbing one of Finn's hands, she extended the other to Adora.

"I'm so happy I finally found you, you wouldn't believe how much I've missed you," Adora began, voice laced with emotion and sincerity . She never breaks eye contact, like she's afraid Catra will disappear if she looks away. Catra broke contact and pulled her hand away. She quickly rummaged in her purse for her phone. Pulling up a new contact, she handed the phone to Adora.

"We'll catch up later, ok? I missed you too," Catra assured as Adora types in her phone number. Their hands brushed as Adora hands back the phone and both women smile as the contact lingered.

"Come on Mama, I wanna finish my drawing!" Finn exclaimed as the pull Catra's hand. She looks down at them with fondness. Sending Adora an apologetic smile and a small wave, she let Finn drag her to her car. Adora gave a small, shocked wave in response, watching as the two drive away from the school parking lot.

from the top

Chapter Summary

the night of the meeting, and a look into the past

Chapter Notes

there are flashbacks throughout this chapter, i hope you can tell where. i hate italicizing flashbacks, so i didn't ;)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"I really don't get how you beat me every time," Adora complained, out of breath. She bent over, resting with her hands on her knees. Catra stood beside her, trying to hide how desperately hard she was breathing.

"I mean it's not very hard when I'm racing the slowest person alive," Catra snickered, looking at Adora's face, mostly obstructed by her ponytail swaying in front of her. Adora scoffed, straightening.

"Am not. We ran the mile in like 13 minutes!" Adora remarked, sounding offended. Catra laughed.

"Yeah, but this is We're talking about. It's hardly competition," Catra smirked, watching Adora roll her eyes and turn to walk up the porch steps. Despite her usual complaining, Catra really was glad to be home. Even if she had just run, trying to beat Adora home. Not that Weaver's was much of a home. Their foster mother had taken them in when they were just 6 years old. Now at 12, the girls were stuck there for the foreseeable future. Weaver wasn't the type to hit often, but boy did she love to yell. One crumb on the table and it's a lecture and extra laundry duty.

Catra followed Adora as she stepped through the front door of Weaver's home. Adora quietly toed her shoes off, placing them on

the rack by the door. Catra closed the door unceremoniously behind her. It closed with a thud, earning a bit of a pleading look from Adora. Catra put up her hands in apology before following suit. Both girls straightened their backpacks before crossing the hallway to the stairs. Their bedroom, along with all of the other kids' were upstairs. As they passed the open living room door, Catra heard Weaver call over her shoulder.

"Catrina, what did I say about slamming the front door?" Weaver called, her voice accusing and irritated. Catra sighed audibly before turning to the doorway.

"Sorry ma'am. Won't happen again," She replied, tone entirely unapologetic. Weaver simply hummed, dismissing the girls with a wave. Adora let out a puff of breath beside her. Though Adora was Weaver's favorite, that didn't mean much. It just meant everyone's mistakes were also somehow her fault.

Once safely inside their shared room, Catra groaned and Adora rolled her eyes at the sound.

"I didn't even do anything! God, Weaver is unbearable. And what is with her calling me Catrina?!" Catra rambled, plopping her backpack by Adora's desk a bit harder than needed.

"I don't know what you were expecting," Adora grumbled, setting her backpack beside Catra's. Every day, the two girls would arrive home from school, be careful to leave their shoes exactly how Weaver said, and tried to go to their room. Weaver always found something to chide Catra about, Catra then complaining about whatever Weaver chose that day.

"Well excuse me for hoping maybe Weaver won't have her head in her ass when we get home," Catra replied, fishing out her school-provided laptop and dropping it on Adora's desk.

"Language," Adora quickly chided, rolling her eyes, "And like you're the optimist here. Let's at least get our homework done before you

complain my ears off.”Catra groaned at the mention of homework despite already planning to do it. She hoisted herself onto the surface of the desk, opening her laptop. Technically, they each had a desk. They just preferred to do homework this way . Catra sitting on the far end cross-legged, laptop on the table in front of her feet. Adora sitting in a chair, her laptop a few inches from Catra’s.

“Fine. But being my best friend means Iget to complain to you for however long Iwant,”Catra finished, settling with her laptop. Adora smiled at the quip.

~

Finn was quiet the majority of the way back to their apartment, seemingly content with staring out the window at the passing car. The kid was little, but boy did they have good timing. As much as catra loved seeing Adora again, it kind of made her want to run. 10 years. It had been 10 years since the day they were torn apart, neither thinking they would see each other again. Truthfully, Catra had been mad at Adora for letting herself be whisked away, leaving Catra behind. But they were just kids then, what was she expected to do?

“Mama?”Finn called from the backseat.

“Yeah kiddo?”Catra responded , looking in the rearview mirror to glance at Finn.

“Why don’t we have a daddy?”they asked, eyes cast down in their lap. Their tail lahed behind them and their ears flattened to their head. Catra took a steading breath as she processed the words. After a minute she sighed. She would never not answer a question of Finn’s, or lie about the answer.

“Well, a few reasons. One is Idon’t want a daddy . Iam one of the people who wants to love girls. Just like people come in all genders, they all love in different ways,”She explained. Sexuality is a bit of a

hard concept to explain to a kid, but she hopes she explained it well enough. Finn is quiet for a moment before they ask again.

"Then why don't we have another mommy?" they inquire, voice smaller than when they asked their first question.

"I'm a little too busy to find one right now. And I guess I haven't met anyone worth finding yet" Catra replied. It was sort of the truth. She was nowhere near too busy to date, her friends an ever-helping babysitting force. But she wasn't lying that she hadn't met someone worth finding. She already found her a long time ago, but she left before she could do anything about it. Since then, no one else has compared.

"Where's this coming from?" Catra asked. Normally, Finn was happy with their life, they didn't really need questions.

"We did projects today about our families and stuff. My family didn't look like everyone else's," they explained. Catra sighed at the admission. Yeah, she got that. She never had a normal family growing up either.

"I wish we had a family," Finn mumbled from their seat, looking out the window.

"We do. You're my family and I'm yours. Families all look different, and ours is just a bit smaller. You'll always have a family," Catra said, her voice strong but emotional. Finn just nodded and kept staring out the car window, watching buildings fly by.

~

"I can't believe you're actually leaving. You're really going to leave me here?" Catra whined from her spot on Adora's bed. Adora looked up from packing her last bag to make eye contact with Catra.

"You know I tried everything I could. I asked for you to come with me, they said no. I asked to stay here, they said no. You know I don't

want to leave you behind,”Adora said, face serious and voice sincere. Yes, rationally, Catra knew that. It didn't keep her from being grumpy all day until Adora was picked up by her new family.

A visitor had come to Weaver’s house 3 weeks earlier. Along with the usual social worker, a tall woman with mocha skin and long, brown haircut in the living room with Weaver. The three women talked for a good 20 minutes, Catra and Adora playing checkers in the family room. Weaver calls out to Adora in her most pleasant voice, the one she only uses around company. Adora made her way to the living room, Catra in tow. Catra reached for Adora’s hand, talking to adults scared Adora more than it did Catra.

Adora’s social worker motioned for the two girls to sit on an empty loveseat. She had learned her lesson trying to separate the girls her first few visits, but never tried again. The social worker introduced the new woman as Mira, a half-sister of Adora. Apparently Mira had only found out about Adora’s existence a few months ago and had been looking for her the whole time. And now she was looking to take her in. The rest of the conversation was a blur. All Catra could hear was a single thought. *Adora’s leaving me.*

~

Adora audibly sighed with relief when Glimmer answered the phone.

“Really Adora? At least Itext and ask if Ican call first,”Glimmer greeted.

“Hey Glimmer, great to hear from you too. Sorry, but this is like really important,”Adora rushed to get out. She had spent her entire ride home in a shocked and panicked state. Catra just showed up. As the mom of one of her students.

“And my morning problems aren't? Uh, what?”Glimmer groaned, not understanding the gravity of the situation.

"I found Catra," Adora blurted, effectively cutting through Glimmer's annoyance. Her friend went silent for a moment on the other end of the line. Without warning, Adora heard the familiar sound of Bow being added to the call.

"Bow, urgent. Adora found Catra," Glimmer relayed, wanting to hear the rest of the news. Bow gasped.

"Like, Catra Catra?! Catra?!" he squealed. Adora gave a watery laugh and affirmative. Adora had told them about Catra years ago, when she graduated highschool and broke down because she always imagined doing it with her. Since then, Glimmer and Bow had been dying to know more about who she was now.

"She's the mom of one of my kids. She came to pick them up and I just-" Adora cut off with a watery choke, "And it was Catra. I gave her my number and I've been waiting ever since I left for her to text."

Glimmer and Bow gave identical squeals. Adora flinched at the sound.

"Oh my god Adora! That's fantastic!" Bow exclaimed. Adora would only imagine the ridiculous smile and watery eyes on his face. Adora gave a nervous laugh.

"It is. But I'm terrified out of my mind."

~

Catra had been grumpy all day. Adora got it, she really did, but she wished her best friend would make their last day together count for a while count. It was only until the hour before Mara was supposed to arrive that Catra seemed to become more sad than irritated.

They spent the hour sitting on Adora's bed, Catra curled into her side, softly purring. Her tail lay in Adora's lap, adora stroking gently down the length of it. They talked idly about everything they were going to miss. As they heard the familiar sound of a car parking in

the driveway, both girls sighed sadly, standing and walking hand-in-hand.

They spent 20 minutes in the foyer, talking with Mira and holding on to each other for their last few moments. Adora noticed Catra seemed nervous and scared more than Adora'd ever seen.

As Mira placed the last of Adora's bags into the back of her car, Catra threw herself into Adora's embrace, holding off tears as her friend held her just as tightly.

"You ready?" Mira asked from behind them. Adora gave no response, just hugged Catra tighter before pulling away. Catra quickly grabbed Adora's face before she could go too far, forcing Adora to look her in the eye. After a moment of what seemed like nervous deliberation, Catra took a deep breath and kissed her.

Catra and Adora had know each other were gay for years, but Adora never though Catra liked her. After a moment of shock, Adora pressed forward and returned the kiss. Catra pulled away, only enough to touch their foreheads together.

"Goodbye, Adora," Catra whispered, a single tear rolling down her cheek.

"Goodbye, Im going to miss you," Adora returned, tears welling in her own eyes.

~

Catra stared at her phone, thumbs hovering over the keyboard. She had a blank text chat open, the receiver, Adora. How does she even begin? She can't just not text, she's Finn's teacher. But how do you open a conversation after 10 years of silence?

Adora

hey adora

its catra

She sent the message, not wanting to overthink it with too much reading. Catra should be happy, right? She has been secretly hoping to find Adora all 10 years they were apart. So why was her stomach churning? She didn't have much time to think about it before the churning turned to butterflies as Adora responded.

Adora

Hey Catra!

So great to hear from you

Just as dorky as when she left at age 15. Catra would usually find people like this annoying, but with Adora it was kind of endearing.

Adora

great to see you again too

Want to grab lunch or something this weekend?

I'd love to catch up :)

sure

lunch sounds great

Great! How's Saturday?

Maybe around noon?

that's good

see you then

See you then!

Catra smiled at her screen. The anxiety was still there, but it was simply background noise to the happiness she felt seeing Adora being her dorky self. Catra knew she had missed Adora, but she didn't think she missed her this much. Today was Monday , Saturday seemed too far and all too soon. She was terrified. And excited out of her mind.

"Mama? Can you tuck me in?" Finn asked from just outside their bedroom door.

"Of course, baby ," Catra replied, standing to do just that. Saying goodnight to Finn was always Catra's favorite time of the day. She returned to bed, finding her heart a little lighter than it was before today.

Chapter End Notes

hehe gay

but yeah this isn't the end of the flashbacks, i think there'll be a few in the next chapter too. hope you enjoy, tthere's more where this came from

to know you again

Chapter Summary

the week leading up to lunch, as well as the rest of the flashbacks

Chapter Notes

the first sentence of flashback scenes are italicized so there, have fun :)

also thanks for all the love on this story, i love reading your comments!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Insolent child! I dedicated my life to raising upstanding members of society, and you go against everything I've taught you? And dragging Adora into it with you? I cannot believe this!" Weaver yelled at Catra, gripping her wrist tightly. Adora had been whisked away less than half an hour ago, and Catra had been screamed out for all that time. She wasn't thinking about the kiss when she did it, she just wanted to do something brave before she never got the chance.

"What sort of manipulation did you do to poor Adora to make you follow her down the path of destruction? You've ruined both of your lives. You will learn from this and become the young woman I raised you to be." Weaver finished, dragging Catra by the hand. Catra's ears were pinned back, flat to her head. Her claws were unsheathed, but she didn't dare use them.

Catra spent the next few weeks in isolation. She was only allowed to leave her room to go to school or the bathroom. For weeks, her only meals were free school lunch. She'd had this punishment many times on a smaller scale, she knew better than to complain. The other kids in the home mostly ignored her, not wanting to face the consequences of going against Shadow Weaver's wishes.

One day, Catra had snuck back a carton of milk and a small pouch of goldfish, saved from her lunch at school that day. Weaver burst into her room, probably checking in to ask if Catra had learned her lesson about living a good life like she had every day. Seeing the contraband peeking out from under Catra's bed, she wordlessly gripped Catra's wrist, dragging her out into the hallway. None of the other kids dared peek out their doors to see what went on.

"First, you ruin your life, as well as Adora's. And now you're going behind my back and undermining the purpose of your punishment. I have just about had enough of you Catrina." Weaver said, her voice cold and angry.

Catra didn't remember much of the rest of that night. What she does remember is asking her school counselor to call her social worker the next day.

~

"Morning, friends!" Adora called from the front of the classroom. Every student at their desk turned to face her.

"Good morning, Ms. Grayskull!" The kids called. This was their morning greeting. A way to effectively grab the students attention, as well as a friendly start to the day.

It was Thursday morning. Day 4 of the new school year , and 4 days since meeting Catra again. They'd been texting occasionally about small things from their days, but never anything bigger. Adora supposed it was best to leave that to lunch.

They started the school year with some get-to-know-you projects. A great way to get kids used to the school routine without delving right into new material. Every kid held a spot in her heart. She spent hours each evening reading over her students' projects, connection was just as important as learning when it came to kids.

Adora couldn't help but treasure Finn's work. They were a connection to the first and only person she'd ever loved. And it helped that they were just like their mother. Energetic, brilliant, and just a little snarky.

On the first day, the class had done a project on their families. 3rd graders were hardly artists, but she knew parents appreciated the family portraits and the kids enjoyed writing about their families. The only kid that didn't seem thrilled to present theirs was Finn. Adora learned that catra was a single mom, Finn and her lived alone. Except for a few aunts (some of Catra's friends for sure) Catra was their only family.

It was saddening to Adora. Every family is just as great as the next, but Catra never had any family. Seeing that she still hadn't found any of them was disheartening.

A small part of Adora wished to be a part of their family. Catra was her only family until age 15, and even then her sister still felt like a stranger.

Days went by and Saturday slowly approached. Despite only knowing them for a few days, Adora was falling deeper in love with Finn each day.

~

"Welcome home, kid. I'll show you around, and we can get you bags unpacked later, alright?" Mira said, opening the front door to Adora's new home. Mira lived in the suburbs just outside Brightmoon, quite a drive from where she grew up in the Fright Zone.

Her social worker had promised Adora that she would do her best to make sure Catra could still see her, but it would be harder now that they weren't in the same home. Adora was terrified out of her mind. This was the first time she could remember doing something big without Catra.

Despite now having a family , it didn't feel like it. Her sister was 10 years older than her, and only related by having the same mother. Apparently Adora's mother died during her birth, and with an absent father, was left to the system. Mira only knew of her existence when she went looking into the mother she didn't remember. She lived with her girlfriend, Hope. Hope was a confusing person. She was not talkative, kind of distant really. But she treated everyone with kindness. Her voice was monotone, but not in the cruel way that weaver's was.

Razz, a great aunt of Adora's, also lived in her new home. She was a bit eccentric, and her speech didn't make sense at times. But Mira said she made great pies and was much wiser than she seemed. Adora actually kind of liked her, she was a nice break from all the seriousness of getting moved out of her foster home.

It took Adora a few weeks to actually feel at home there, but eventually she found her footing in this new family. The only thing missing from her new life was Catra. Only a week after Adora's move, Weaver's home got shut down. Because of no familial ties, Adora's social worker was unable to get the information on where Catra was moved to.

I've lost her , Adora thought.

~

Friday night, Catra called Scorpia. They'd met Catra's senior year of highschool, right before she'd become pregnant with Finn. They've been best friends ever since, even if they were polar opposites.

"Hey Wildcat! What's up?" Scorpia greeted, picking up the phone.

"Hey Scorpia. I need to ask a favor," Catra replied, getting right to the point. Catra wasn't one to ramble before asking.

"Need me to watch Finn?" Scorpia asked, already knowing. Catra asked Scorpia to babysit a lot. Being one of the only close friends she has and the only person she'd trust with her kid at the moment meant Scorpia was frequenting their apartment.

"Yeah, I'm going out for lunch," Catra aid unceremoniously.

"Oh, with who?" Scorpia questioned. Listen, Scorpia is Catra's best friend. But Catra also doesn't do excited. Or emotions in general for that matter. And those just happen to be Scorpia's favorite things.

"Don't make a big deal about it, but Adora. She's Finn's new teacher and we're just going to catch up."

"Oh my gosh! Wildcat, I'm so happy for you! I knew you'd find her one day!" Scorpia exclaimed from the other end of the call. Catra

moved the phone away from her ear, not wanting to go deaf to Scorpia's shrieking.

"Yeah, yeah. I'm happy for me too," Catra said, trying to drive away from those topics.

"So what are you going to do?" Scorpia asked, no context to the question.

"What am I going to do with what?" Catra questioned accusingly.

"With Adora! Come on. Your first love. First and only friend until 15. You're going to be friends, right?" Scorpia elaborated. Catra cringed at her wording. Yeah, maybe Scorpia knew too much.

"Scorpia," Catra started, "I don't know. I'd like to but there's a lot of stuff around her leaving that I'm not sure I want to get in to."

"Maybe this is a push from the universe. Maybe Adira is here to help you heal," Scorpia encouraged, her voice sickeningly sincere.

"You are spending way too much time with Perfuma. You're starting to sound like her," Catra dismissed. As much as she hated Perfuma's hippie mumbo-jumbo, Scorpia had a point. Maybe it was time to face her past. Maybe it was time to stop running.

"Well, I'll be there tomorrow. I hope your night goes well," Scorpia replied, seemingly unbothered by Catra's quip. They shared goodbyes and eventually Catra ended the call.

"Mama?" Catra heard Finn call from the end of the living room.

"What's up?" Catra asked, patting the couch beside her, inviting Finn to sit.

"Were you talking to Aunt Scorpia?" They asked, sitting on the couch.

"Yeah. I'm going to lunch with a friend and she's gonna come play with you," Catra answered, pulling Finn into her lap. She placed a kiss in their hair, right between their ears. They let out a happy trill at the affection.

"Are you going to see Ms Grayskull?" They asked, all too knowing. Catra smiled at her kid's already sharp mind.

"Yes. We're going to go talk for a bit," Catra supplied, hoping the questions ended there.

"I like her . She's nice. And pretty," Finn supplied with a smile. Catra rolled her eyes and laughed at the comment.

"I like her too, kiddo. Come on, let's get you to bed so you can wake up earlier than me and watch cartoons all morning," Catra dismissed, already lifting Finn from her lap. Finn giggled, that's exactly what they were going to do.

~

"Scorpia, what am I going to do?" Catra sobbed. She sat on the floor of Scorpia's room, having collapsed in tears after shutting the door.

"Oh Catra. I'm so sorry this must be really hard. But what you do is up to you. Let's talk to my moms about getting you an OBGYN appointment first," Scorpia comforted. Always the one to be calm in times of crisis. Catra only sobbed harder.

The past few weeks has been torture for Catra. Her last foster home was a dump. An alcoholic dad and a mother who was never home. One night, her foster dad came home, drunk out of his mind. He raped her. She couldn't tell anyone for fear of him treating her like Weaver did. Once she broke down about it in front of Scorpia, her moms had gotten their fostering license revoked and her foster dad sent to prison.

And now she had found out she was pregnant. After feeling sick for weeks and her period being 2 weeks late, a pregnancy test from the drugstore confirmed it. What was she to do?

She was 17. Not out of highschool, not for another 3 months anyway. She lived with her best friend's parents after her foster home got shut down, and had no plans for college.

Everything in Catra's rational mind told her to get rid of the baby. Or at least put it up for adoption. But a month later, at her 2nd ultrasound, she decided she couldn't do it. The life inside her felt more rewarding than anything in her life did. And she could never leave a child to live the life she did.

Finn was born from tragedy, but never represented it. Finn was the best thing to have ever happened to Catra.

Chapter End Notes

ok guys, thats's the end of the rape/non-con tag. just put it there as a precaution :)

anyway....

Catra's a good mom and Adora still loves her after 10 years

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all patrons are appreciated greatly!

lunch date

Chapter Summary

lunch and therapy lol

Chapter Notes

hi, i come bearing gay

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora sat at a booth in theBrighmoon Diner , waiting for her guest. Maybe less of a guest and more of a friend. Adora didnt know . They had agreed on this spot last night, and now Adora anxiously wrung her hands in her lap as she waited. Every ring of the bell of the diner door had Adora turning her head.

After what felt like years of nervous waiting, Adora looked to the door as it opened, seeing Catra walk in. Ctra didnt notice her right away , but once they met eyes, she gave a small smile and wave. Adora returned the gesture, inviting her to sit.

Catra slid into the other side of the booth, setting her bag down on the bench beside her.

"Hey , Adora,"Catra greeted as she settled. Adora smiled at the familiar greeting.

"Hey Catra. So great to actually talk," Adora replied, smile turning a touch nervous. "So, how did you end up in Brightmoon?"

"Well, I wanted to get out of the Fright Zone, small town fever and all. Brightmoon just happened to be close by and have an affordable college," Catra supplied. Adora supposed that made sense, she would have done the same thing had she aged out of the foster system. "What about you? It's been so long. I bet your story's a bit more exciting."

"Right. After I got adopted, I lived with Mara and a few other people from my family just outside Brightmoon. I decided in my last few years of high school that I wanted to be a teacher, so I went to BMU for that. I work at the elementary school now, obviously, and that's pretty much it," Adora explained. A little standard in the scheme of stories, but with a childhood like theirs, normal was just about the best thing Adora could ask for.

"That's great. I'm really glad you got to do something you love. Not to mention you're really good at," Catra said. The Catra that Adora left 10 years ago would have said something snarky, playfully insult her maybe. She guessed a lot had changed since then.

"Thanks, I guess. But what about you? What do you do? Like for a living or just what happened out of college?" Adora asked. She had told just about her whole story, but felt like Catra hadn't shared nearly as much. Adora hoped it was just nerves keeping Catra from talking and not discomfort.

~

Catra was hoping she wouldn't ask that. The whole way to lunch, she was dreading adora actually finding out what she did. Adora went to a good college, became a teacher, and gets to shape young minds with her kind heart. Catra was nothing compared to that.

It's not nearly as good a story as yours, but all right,"Catra led with, steeling herself for Adora's disappointment. "I aged out of the system a little after my best friend's moms got their fostering license. I went to Brightmoon Community College for Communications and now I work in marketing for a non-profit one of my friends runs."

"Oh wow . That' s great! Looks like we both turned out alright given our childhoods,"Adora laughed. That was...not what she was expecting? Adora had always been weird about addressing how shitty their foster mother was when they were teenagers. Catra guessed Adora was a lot more different than she seemed.

"Y eah. I guess,"Catra said, hesitant. Adora' s small giggle faded.

"Hey , I know it' s been a really long time, but I'm still Adora. I'm a bit different, but you don't need to hold back,"Adora encouraged, a small, nervous smile playing at her lips. It reminded her of the day Adora left. She shouldn't be thinking about that right now .

"Since when do you know what to say in emotional situations?" Catra joked. Adora was always a bit dense with emotions, even if she didn't actively avoid them like Catra did.

"There she is," Adora said, her voice a little sing-songy. "I really did miss you, you know. I hope you weren't as good at sarcasm as you are." Catra was surprised. Now a mother and 25, she knows better than her teenage self. But for years, Catra imagined Adora not missing her and maybe forgetting about her existence entirely.

"I missed you too," Catra assured, sensing Adora's slight discomfort at expressing vulnerability. That was always frowned upon by Weaver. Catra did miss Adora, but she doubts it was in the way Adora missed her. Catra was absolutely heartbroken when Adora left, wishing she'd said what she really wanted the day she left. Instead, she said "Goodbye, Adora."

The two women spent the next 2 hours in that booth of the Brightmoon Diner. The food was average, the service sub-par, but the company was the best Catra could ever ask for. Now that she sat here, Catra could never imagine leaving. She had severely underestimated exactly how much she'd missed just hearing Adora's voice. They spoke about their friends, jobs, and life drama. Even down to the smallest details, it was like they knew each other almost as well as they did at age 15. A few things were different, but Adora still had the brightest laugh, hard-working spirit, and kindest heart she knew as a kid.

They only stopped talking over lunch when an alarm from Adora's phone rang.

"Oh my god, Ididn't realize how late it was getting! Ive got to get going, can't be late to my appointment,"Adora explained, tone a bit frantic as she gathered her bag and waved their server down for the check.

"Appointment for what? If it's ok Iask,"Catra questioned. What was so urgent just piqed her interest.

"No, it's ok. Just therapy . Ireally do gotta run though,"Adora finished. She seemed so casual about it. One more thing 15-year-old Adora wouldn't do.

"Oh, well good luck. This was great,"Catra said, rising to gather her things. It was a bit awkward to let Adora leave by herself. Their server came back with their check, and Catra reached into her purse for her wallet. A hand fell on top of hers and she looked up to see Adora handing the server a card.

"This one's on me. Y ou can pay next time, ok?"Adora explained, looking hopeful. So that meant next time was a possibility. That shouldn't have made Catra's stomach flutter with a swarm of butterflies, but here she was, blush rising to her cheeks. Not that Adora could tell, the fine fur of her face covering the color.

"I'll hold you to that. Nice seeing you, Adora,"Catra said, reaching out a hand for a handshake as their server walked away. Adora didn't take the hand, but stepped forward to sweep Catra up in a

hug. Not what she was expecting, but certainly not unwelcome. Catra turned her head into Adora's neck as she wrapped her arms around her back. She forgot how comforting and nice Adora smelled..

~

One perk of growing up with a magicat best friend: you learn all of their behaviors. Adora used to think she'd memorized just Catra (she did) but now she sees it applies to most magicats.

When this comes in handy is dealing with one of the most emotionally unavailable people to have graced the earth. To most people, Catra would have looked impassive most of their lunch. But Adora noticed the little things.

The small twitch of her tail on the bench behind her when she found something especially interesting. The slight twitch in her ear when she heard something she disliked. The way her ears perked forward when Adira laughed.

But most importantly, the way her tail did a full sweep when she was flustered.

As Adora pulled her into a hug, she noticed it. She wasn't thinking about the gesture as she did it, but she did think about that reaction.

She probably shouldn't read into it that much, Catra was just shocked, that's all. Wishful thinking would get her nowhere. She was Finn's teacher for star's sake.

Maybe though, Adora's feelings for Catra never faded.

Adora came out shortly after Catra, even if it was only to Catra herself. She knew she liked Catra, but didn't realize it was love until she left. Just a day too late.

She pulled into the parking lot of her therapist's office, steeling herself. Expressing emotional vulnerability was still tough for her after all these years, but biweekly sessions with Perfuma helped over time.

"Hello, Adora! Welcome back," Perfuma greeted from her spot on the floor. Perfuma's methods were a hit unconventional, but it helped so Adora didn't question them anymore.

"Hey Perfuma," Adora returned, sitting across from her on a cushion. She set her bag down next to her, getting in position for their meditation to start her session.

Finishing the small meditation, Perfuma opened the session as she always did.

"Do you have anything outstanding you'd like to talk about today?" Most days, Adora didn't. They'd talk about her week, and discuss whatever issues popped up in conversation. Today was one of the few times she did have something outstanding.

"Actually , yeah. It's kind of big and has some emotions around it, so sorry in advance if I get distant," Adora warned. Perfuma of all people knew this best, but Adora's training to detach herself from emotions for her own protection often caused her to space out when expressing strong emotion. That was one of the reasons Perfuma was so great. She understood. She taught Adora words like trauma response, disassociation, and panic attack. She never judged or pushed.

"You know you never need to apologize. Go ahead," Perfuma prompted.

"School started this week," Adora led, trying to say what she really wanted to. "And I found Catra."

Perfuma's neutral face of encouragement shifted to curiosity and slight shock. "Really? How?"

"She's the mom of one of my kids. Their name is Finn. I actually just came back from lunch with Catra," Adora explained. She didn't know why, but she felt like she needed to justify herself.

"And how do you feel about finding Catra again?" Perfuma asked, somehow knowing exactly what to say.

"Happy . Very happy. And scared. Like really really scared," Adora admitted. Perfuma hummed in acknowledgement, waiting for more. When Adora didn't speak, she prompted her again.

"Why are you scared?" Perfuma asked. Adora took a deep breath. Explaining her emotions was always the hardest part of this.

"I just-" Adora sighed, "It doesn't feel real. I really thought I lost her . For good. I only knew I loved her when I left, and now she's back. And the mother of one of my students for star's sake!"

Perfuma stopped writing in her notepad, as she had been while Adora talked to give her an encouraging smile.

"Perfuma, I don't know what to do. I think I might still love her . And Finn is just like her when she was their age. I'm scared because I don't want to lose her. I already did once and we all know how that went."

"Why do you think you'll lose her?" Perfuma questioned. It wasn't really a question, Perfuma already knew . She just wanted Adora to

get there on her own. Adora was silent for a moment, looking at her hands in her lap.

"I guess I just don't think she'll want me anymore. Or I'll scare her off. Like maybe if I get too close, it'll just push her away."

Perfuma smiled at her, the proud smile she gave whenever Adora reached the root of a problem.

"Your fear is understandable. Justified, even. But you can't let fear hold you back. It's hard to overcome fear when you lived in it for so long, but you've come so far. How can you move past your fear?" Perfuma said, inviting Adora to think about her solutions.

"I guess through action. Sitting here and worrying won't get me where I want," Adora answered.

"And what do you want?" Perfuma asked. "They've been working on this question for years. Spending her whole childhood being told what she should want, and what she had to do made that question hard to answer.

"I don't know," Adora answered truthfully, "but I think I can start with friends."

Chapter End Notes

therapy is great, i've been in it for like a year so i tried my best to make it realistic

next update coming whenever, you all should know i don't have a schedule by now

also how do you guys feel abt a time skip in like 2 chapters? just by a few months cuz i don't feel like dragging this out for 20 chapters. unless you guys are into that, which ok. i'm here to serve the gays

friends

Chapter Summary

an empty saturday night and two clueless gays

Chapter Notes

hey guys! it's been a little longer than usual since the last chapter so... almost 2k words for you. enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Mama!" Finn exclaimed as Catra walked through the door of Scorpia's house. Finn ran towards her for a hug, Catra opening her arms in invitation. It had only been a few hours, but she thought his enthusiasm was cute.

"Hey Finn! You have fun?" She asked. Finn nodded vigorously before tugging Catra's hand to drag her across the room, to a drawing they must have been working on until Catra walked in.

"Auntie Scorpia and me watched my show and then we ate grilled cheese. And I med this!" Finn babbled, holding the drawing up to their mom's face. Catra took the paper in her hands.

The drawing was of Finn and Catra, a common occurrence. But today there was another person there, holding Catra's other hand.

"Who's that?" Catra questioned. Fin giggled.

It's Ms Grayskull! You guys are friends so I drew her too!" They explained. Catra shook her head and snorted. Not really, their relationship was more complicated than that. But how will she explain that to this kid?

"We sure are, kid. Let's go, say thank you to Auntie Scorpia," Catra dismissed. Referring to Adora as her friend was weird.

"Bye Auntie Scorpia! Thank you!" Finn called out, grabbing their bag. Scorpia sweeped them in a hug after their backpack was slung over their shoulders.

"Bye Finn, come play again soon. And bye Catra, tell me all about lunch later," Scorpia said with a smile.

~

The following weeks after lunch, life mostly continued as normal. Adora did her morning workout, went to work, and came home and graded. She had movie nights with Bow and Glimmer on Fridays, and went grocery shopping on Sundays. Bi-weekly therapy on Saturday evenings. Some things had changed though. She texted Catra every day, about the most mundane things. She carved out time on Saturdays to see Catra. And Bow and Glimmer became insufferable.

But one thing had changed monumentally. Adora was diagnosed with Panic Disorder at age 17. Frequent panic attacks, constant anxiety, and chronic insomnia plagued her for years until she was diagnosed by a psychiatrist.

But panic never set in around Catra. Or Finn of that matter. Something about the way Catra existed erased every thought from her mind.

Right now though, she was seething with anxious energy as she sit in her living room with Bow and Glimmer.

"So...how was your day?" Glimmer asked, her voice sing-songy. Adora raised an eyebrow in her direction. Ever since Bow and Glimmer arrived for their weekly movie night, they'd both been acting weird.

"Can you just say what this is all about? Because I'm getting tired of trying to figure it out myself," Adora pleaded, hoping for answers. Glimmer giggled and Bow silently scolded her. It only made Glimmer laugh harder. Bow sighed.

"Glimmer and I would like to talk to you about something," Bow led, elbowing Glimmer in the ribs to stop her laughter.

"Oh, no. Why do I feel like I'm about to be given a lecture?" Adora said, nervous. She knew exactly what they were talking about.

Adora’s life hadnt changed except for one thing.

"Y ou're totally still in love with Catra right?" Glimmer questioned, her laugh not completely gone from her tone. Adora gaped in shock at Glimmer’s bluntness.

"Glimmer! Sorry , Adora. Imean that is where this conversation was headed but Iwas going to be a *lit*e more gentle about it," Bow explained. Adora sighed, a nervous giggle accompanying the sound.

Tey werent wrong. Adora may have only noticed she loved Catra when shed kissed Adora goodbye, but she didnt miss how deep her love ran. Now with Catra back in her life, even with how little she had, all of those feelings from her early teenage years flooded back.

"Ok, maybe. But what do you want me to do? Catra's only been back in my life for a month. And she has a kid. Who's one of my students h case you forgot," Adora defended. Bow looked saddened, but Glimmer just looked annoyed.

"Oh, please. What Iwant you to do is tell her! Asked her out on a date, maybe," Glimmer answered with an annoyed huf f.

"Y ou don't get it. Im not going to scare her away just as she and her kid show up. Imissed her a lot and Iwon't risk losing her over my

friends being annoyed Iwon't tell her my feelings,"Adora explained, her voice more sad than annoyed. Glimmer's face softened.

I"know . You get to decide when and if you do it, but at least think about telling her. t's not healthy to bottle those feelings up,"Bow said, placing a hand on her shoulder. Glimmer sighed in surrender, opening her arms for a group hug.

~

Catra sighed audibly, relishing in the space and hating it. Finn was out with Scorpia and her new girlfriend, so Catra was kid-free on a Friday evening.

Tfie silence and emptiness of her one-bedroom apartment was nearly suffocating. And Catra hated herself for what she wanted to fill the space.

Her phone screen glared with the open message thread, the name at the top mocking her. With resigned determination, she began typing.

Adora

hey

im bored and kid-free

wanna hang?

Catra anxiously waited for a response. Only 4 minutes passed, but each second dragged on tenfold. Her phone pinged with a notification, and Catra should've been embarrassed by how fast she picked up the object.

Sure!

my place ok?

Of course! Send me the address, I'll come over!

You shared your location

see u soon

She'll never admit it, but Adora's excitement and immediate responses made a blush rise to Catra's cheek. Maybe she wasn't completely over Adora. Who was she kidding? She never could've been.

About 20 minutes later, a knock sounded at Catra's front door. She couldn't help the excited perk of her ears and a small lash of her tail.

Opening the door, she was met with the nervous yet excited, absolutely dorky, face of Adora. She smiled at the familiar sight.

"Hey Adora, that was fast," Catra greeted, stepping aside to let Adora in. Adora smiled softly at the quip, shaking her head.

"Not like I have anything better to do. Or anything to do at all for that matter," Adora dismissed, walking through the door . Catra closed it behind her and gestured to the couch.

"Make yourself at home, I guess. You want something to drink?" Catra asked. Adora simply shook her head and sat on the couch, her anxiety obvious in her posture.

Catra sat on the unoccupied end of the couch, leaning against the arm and pulling one leg to rest on the seat.

"So, how have you been?" Adora prompted, a little awkwardly . Catra rolled her eyes at the tension in Adora's air, but answered the question anyway .

"Pretty great. I found a job I think I'm going to apply for , Finn's doing great, and I'm actually doing well keeping up with my friends," Catra replied. Adora smiled at the long response. When they were teenagers, the answer to that question was always 'fine'. "How about you? I'm sure your life is more exciting."

"Not really . Ihave a lot of grading to do, but luckily 3rd graders can't write more than a few paragraphs. Im looking for a new place though, my lease is up in 6 months and Idon't really want to stay there,"Adora told, gesturing with her hands as she spoke.

"Can Iask why"?Catra qestioned. Adora smiled.

"Iwant a place with a yard. Ive only told a few people this, but Iwant to get a service dog and they need the space,"Adora explained. Catra was confused. A service dog for what?

"Why a service dog"?

"Panic disorder ,"she replied. Catra's confusion only grew . Since when?Adora seemed to sense her confusion and continued. "Don't feel bad if you couldn't tell. Ive had great practice hiding it. Plus, I hardly ever get panicked with you around."

Despite the slightly joking tone in Adora's voice, Catra felt her words meant a lot more than circumstance. For some reason, the thought of Adora not panicking around her made her heart flutter. Since when did Catra's heart flutter?

"W ell Ihope you find something. And get that service dog,"Catra remarked, realizing she had been silent for a moment. Adora's face

was anxious for the moment of silence, seeming to worry if she'd said too much.

~

Adora stayed for a few more hours, she'd lost count. Something about Catra kept her there. Maybe it was the soothing way her voice washed over Adora, and the comfort her scent brought to her mind. Maybe it was just that Catra's very presence made all of her worries float away.

One thing had been on her mind though, and the glass of wine she'd shared with Catra gave her the courage to ask about it.

"You don't have to answer if this is too personal, but I'm just curious. How did Finn come along?" Adora asked. Catra seemed taken aback by the question, the wine glass in her hand shaking almost imperceptibly. "I'm sorry, I see that's-" Adora was cut off by Catra setting her glass down and gesturing for Adora to stop. She shut her mouth dutifully, unwilling to make this any more awkward than it already was.

"No, I'd like you to know what happened after you left," Catra began, seemingly preparing herself. "After you left, Weaver got worse. She hit me enough to leave marks and her fostering license was revoked. I bounced between homes for about a year before my second to last."

Catra stopped. Adora was slightly scared. The story got worse from here surely. She wasn't so sure she wanted to hear it anymore. But then again, she had to know how this kid she had begun to love came about.

"My last foster dad was an alcoholic. He's Finn's biological father, but he's also in prison now. I moved in with a friend from highschool and her moms took care of me even after I aged out of the system," Catra finished. Adora was horrified. Not about Weaver, or bouncing between homes. She had expected that. But her foster dad? What kind of a monster-

"He raped you?" Adora asked, surprising herself with her blunt wording. Catra cringed at the word but nodded sadly, not lifting her head to meet Adora's eyes. Adora cursed whatever higher power existed in the universe for allowing that to happen to someone like Catra. Someone who'd already been through enough. "That man is a monster. You were just a kid! I'm so sorry, I would've never asked. I didn't want to bring that up for you."

"No, it's ok. That was 8 years ago. And Finn is one of the best things to ever happen to me. Besides, I wanted you to know," Catra assured her, a watery but genuine smile settling on her lips. Adora gently smiled back. Since when were Catra's lips so beautiful?

"Thank you for telling me, then. Either way, I'm glad they're here. They remind me a lot of you actually," Adora supplied, hoping to steer the conversation in a brighter direction.

"Really?" Catra asked, the brightness returning to her voice.

"Yeah. Energetic, a little snarky, and brilliant. It's no wonder they're such a great kid with a mom like you," Adora praised. Though it may seem a little cliche, every word was true.

"I can't take all the credit. They're great all on their own," Catra replied, voice a little wistful as she thought about her kid. The motherly love in her eyes was something that warmed Adora's heart. Catra met Adora's eyes and openly stared with the same affection twinkling in her eyes. Adora felt more at home than she had since ce their last night sleeping in the same bed at 15.

Chapter End Notes

> eh he don't worry , we'll get more angry adora later. comments are my lifeblood, please leave them and kudos if you liked this chapter!

the moments between

Chapter Summary

The night after and late-night thoughts

Chapter Notes

Hey so this chapter is kinda short sorry , but Ifelt like Ineeded a filler before the next chapter so here you go

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora stayed for a grand total of 5 hours before heading back to her own home. Catra immediately felt the loss of Adora's presence. She really was fucked. Eventually, Scorpia and her new girlfriend bring Finn back from their evening out.

Finn dragged a tall, tan woman with flowing blonde hair behind them as they pushed past their mom with a quick hello. They looked like they were about to start talking, but paused and experimentally sniffed the air.

"Mama, was Ms Grayskull here?" Finn asked, eyes wide. Catra often forgot she wasn't the only magicat around anymore.

"Yeah, we were hanging out while you were having fun," Catra explained, hoping that was the end of the conversation. Finn narrowed their eyes at Catra, but resigned to let it be for the moment.

"This is Perfuma. She's so nice and she took me and Auntie Scorpia to the fair!" Finn exclaimed. At least Catra didn't have to explain Adora to them anymore.

"Hi Perfuma, nice to meet you. Finn behave themself?" Catra greeted. Perfuma held out a hand for a handshake. They shook hands and Perfuma smiled warmly.

"Nice to meet you too. Scorpia talks about you and Finn a lot. And they were just an angel, don't worry," Perfuma said, her voice warm and happy. It was almost alarming how sweet the woman seemed. A walking cavity. But Catra supposed that's exactly the type of person Scorpia needed.

"Go get jammies and start your bath. I'll be right here if you need help," Catra instructed Finn. They groaned, but walked towards their bedroom. Catra smiled as she watched them go.

"You said you had a Miss Grayskull over? That wouldn't happen to be Adora, would it?" Perfuma asked conversationally. She had turned to tuck into Scorpia's side while Catra talked to Finn. They were actually really cute together.

"Yeah, actually. You know her?" Catra replied. What a small world. Not that there are many people named Grayskull anyway.

"Oh yes. We've had mutual friends since highschool. She's one of my clients as well," Perfuma answered.

"We actually met through Adora," Scorpia supplied. "She knew of me through you, and said Perfuma and I would get along well."

"That's great. Well, I'm glad you guys were able to have fun tonight. And Perfuma, take care of Scorpia. Alright?" Catra said.

"I'm planning on it. Have a good night, Catra," Perfuma answered, motioning for Scorpia to follow her out. the two women left and Catra was left with Finn. They finished their bath and emerged in fresh pajamas.

"Mama?" They called, entering the living room. Catra turned to face them, a quilted eyebrow promoting them to ask whatever it is that they wanted.

"Are you and Ms Grayskull still going to lunch tomorrow?" Finn questioned, sitting beside Catra on the couch. Catra pulled them into her side.

"I'm not sure, kid," Catra replied. She wasn't, not really. They'd just spent 5 hours talking and drinking, but Saturdays were their days to talk.

"Ok. But if you do go to lunch with her , ca. Icome?" They finished, yawning. Catra smiled fondly. Her childhood best friend, her former everything, and her child seemed to get along well.

"Sure. Idon't see why not," Catra answered. The idea felt strangely like family.

~

Adora drove home in a daze, completely on autopilot. What was she doing? Spending every Saturday with Catra, going to her apartment, telling her about her mental health and her dream of getting a service dog? No point in trying to bury her feelings at this point.

t wasn't her love for Catra that scared her the most though, that she'd had time to kick herself about. But it was her love for Finn. Adora loved all of her students, she wanted to watch them grow and thrive. But with Finn, it was so much deeper than that. She wanted to watch them grow, share their life with them. Wanted to spoil them with gifts and love. She never gave special treatment in school, she was better than that. But Adora always wanted to take Finn home at the end of a day.

Adora's phone pinged with the familiar sound of a text notification.

Catra

still wanna go for lunch tomorrow?

Sure!

finn wants to come if thats ok

They're always welcome

Yep, really not helping the whole loving Catra and her kid thing. Seeing the late hour, Adora started on her nightly routine. As she prepared for bed, she got a call from Perfuma.

"Hey Perfuma, what's up?" Adora greeted when she answered the phone. As far as she knew, Perfuma was spending the day with her girlfriend, Catra's best friend.

"Hello Adora. I'm not sure if I told you, but Scorpia and I took Finn out for the day," Perfuma explained. Adora did not know that, but it made sense given that Catra was home and kid-free tonight.

"You didn't, but that's great," Adora replied. Perfuma hummed in acknowledgment.

"I just thought you'd like to know something. I thought it was heartwarming," Perfuma began. "Finn talks about you. Quite a lot, actually. They really like you, you know that? They kept talking about how nice, pretty, and patient you are. And they said, and I quote, 'But the best thing is she makes my Mama happy'"

Adora's heart stopped. Finn really said that about her?

"Oh, wow . Thanks for telling me that just made my entire week," Adora said, her voice a little watery with emotion. Tomorrow was going to be a good day.

~

Catra lay awake, staring at the ceiling. She turned her head to look at her alarm clock, seeing the time as almost 2 am. She groaned softly in frustration.

By all means, today was great. She spent hours with Adora, saw her best friend and her new girlfriend, and spent the night playing with Finn while she got them ready for bed.

One thing nagged at the back of her mind, though.

When Adora miraculously reappeared in her life, Catra swore to herself that she would not let that turn her world upside down. Yet here she is, lying awake, thinking how warm and light the thought of she and Adora spending a Saturday afternoon with Finn.

She knew she still had feelings for Adora, she couldn't deny that after her whole journey for emotional awareness or whatever Scorpia called it.

But Catra hated herself for almost telling Adora she loved her every time a quiet moment arose. She hated glancing down at Adora's lips as she spoke. She hated the images that rose to her mind late at night, when tension had to be released.

But most of all, she hated looking at Adora and thinking what a wonderful addition to their family she would be.

Chapter End Notes

Next update we get Saturday afternoon with family grayskull-applesauce and PROTECT ADORA

comments are the only part of my diet, so pleas leave them Iam eternally grateful for all my readers

family?

Chapter Summary

First family saturday pt 1

A lunch at dryl and some cute moments with Finn

Chapter Notes

So Istarted writing this chapter and realized it was already over a thousand words so Im breaking it up into 2 chapters

Enjoy pt 1!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

A soft knock sounded at the front door, and Finn's ears perked up as they charged out of their mother's grasp. Catra let them go with a sigh. She *had* been trying to get Finn into their coat, but nothing could stop that kid from running off. One of the many things Catra wished they hadn't inherited.

Finn ran to the door, unlocking it with a click and small laugh. They flew the door open, revealing a shocked Adora.

Ms Grayskull! Hi! Finn greeted, already grabbing Adora's hand and dragging her inside. Adora laughed and let herself be led. Seeing Finn hadn't closed the door behind them, Catra walked behind the pain to shut it.

"Hi Finn! And you can call me Adora when we're not at school, you know," Adora replied as Finn slowed to a stop. They simply turned back with a confused expression.

"Your name is Adora? I thought it was Ms Grayskull," Finn questioned. Catra giggled at the question while Adora looked down at them with affection. The look really suited her .

"Yes, my name is Adora. You call teachers by their last names and mine is Grayskull," Adora explained. Finn still looked confused, but let it go.

"Hey Adora, thanks for coming over again. Finn really wanted to spend the day with you," Catra said, placing a hand on Adora's shoulder from behind. Adora simply turned her head and smiled.

"Of course. Anything for my 2 favorite people."

Catra flushed. The words had no real deeper meaning behind them, but for some reason they sounded like honey when they came from Adora's lips. That's a train of thought she probably shouldn't go down right now.

"Ok, now that Adora's here, can we please finish putting on your coat?" Catra asked Finn. They gave a small giggle and ran up to their mom.

"It's not even that cold, Mama," they protested. Catra rolled their eyes. Sometimes talking to Finn was like talking to a younger her.

"October weather is no joke, Finn. I once knew someone who got a cold because he didn't wear his coat," Catra chided. It was mostly true. He had gotten a cold from the October chill, but he didn't have a coarse because he had ripped the sleeve of the only one Weaver would buy him for the winter. Finn didn't need to know that part.

"Oh yeah," Adora chimed in from behind her, "He got probably the worst cold I've ever seen that year!"

Catra had almost forgotten how nice it was to have someone to look back on her childhood fondly. Finn laughed at that, and their laugh sounded like the carefree childhood Catra always wished she had. At least she got to give that childhood to someone else.

"I'm hungry, let's go to Bow for lunch!" Finn exclaimed, already grabbing Adora and pulling her towards the door. Adora once again let herself be led, smiling down at Finn with exasperated fondness. Catra followed the two out the door and to her car.

~

The bell above the entrance to Dyl rang as Adora stepped through, Finn trailing only half a step behind. Both they and their mother winced a bit at the noise. The world still wasn't caught up with hybrid inclusion, Adora supposed.

"Auntie Entrapta!" Finn called as they spotted a short frame with long purple pigtails. The figure turned around and Adora saw someone she recognized as Catra's other close friend from her social media.

"Hello, Finn! And Catra! And other person I haven't met!" Entrapta greeted. She was sat at a table near the back of the small cafe, the surface thoroughly covered with small electronic components. Finn ran up and briefly hugged the woman before she turned back to her components.

"This is Adora, Finn wanted to come here for lunch. They also said they wanted to see 'Wrong Hordak' while we were here," Catra said, seemingly unphased by Entrapta's focus on her work. Entrapta didn't look up from the components she bonded, but replied with an enthusiastic tone.

"Oh hi Adora! Catra talks about you so much, no need to tell me about yourself. And Wilbur is in the kitchen," she finished. Catra chuckled, at what exactly Adora could not tell, and Finn bounded off to the counter.

Dyll seemed to be a small, family cafe. It had a decently sized menu of lunch food, but it was all miniature. Everyone has to have a shtick she supposed. Finn propped their chin on the counter and Catra walked up behind them. Adora followed closely behind. A tall, pale man noticed their arrival and turned to greet them.

"Catra. Finn. Nice to see you," he greeted. "And you are?"

"Adora, Hordak. Hordak, Adora. Can you ask Wilbur to come out here? Finn wants to say hi," Catra answered. Apparently this group doesn't do small talk.

"Ah, yes, your usual for the two of you I suppose. And what will the new one be having?" Hordak asked as he turned to wave someone over from inside the kitchen.

"The Entrapta Special, please. She'll love it," Catra said, answering for Adora. She was thoroughly confused, but found the chaotic dynamics comforting.

After an enthusiastic hug and greeting with Wilbur, or Wrong Hordak as Finn called him, the trio sat at a table to await their order. A small, rolling robot arrived at their table with a tray, and Catra unloaded their food and drinks from it before sending it off. Entrapta really must be a genius.

Catra set a large plate with a large assortment of tiny food in front of Adora, a sparkle in her eye.

"Okay , what's with the look?" Adora asked, an eyebrow quilted in a questioning look.

"What are you talking about?" Catra replied, seeming to genuinely not understand the question.

"That look you do when you think something's gonna be fun. Like before you pull a prank, or crack a joke," Adora explained. She honestly didn't think she was the only one to notice it. Finn giggled, hiding their face behind a furred hand.

"And you do it too, kid. Saw it when you tackled your mom on the walk to the car," Adora returned. Finn stopped laughing for a second, only to laugh harder.

"Uh, whatever . I'm excited to see you try Wilbur's food!" Catra explained, spark still in her eyes. Adora rolled her eyes and held what looked to be a miniature pig up to her mouth. She took a single bite, and immediately was shell shocked. Her face must have shown it because both Catra and Finn burst into tearful laughter.

"That's the face! Everyone makes that face the first time they eat here," Finn supplied, still fighting giggles.

"It's so good! How have I never known about this place?" Adora exclaimed.

"No idea. Given how much you like food, I'm surprised you don't know every restaurant in Brightmoon," Catra teased, snatching a sample from Adora's plate. Adora feigned offence and took the morsel right back from Catra's hand.

"Ok, rude! You know I only order from the same 15 places," Adora countered. They had in fact discussed this a few weeks before. While she finished her sentence and attempted to take another bite, a small hand grabbed the miniature flower-shaped bite from her hand. Adora looked over to see Finn chewing on the very stolen bite, and gaped at them.

"My god, you are just like your mom! How dare you corrupt such a child?" Adora exclaimed to Catra, who only pulled Finn into a side hug and laughed. Finn wriggled out of her grip, grumbling. After a kiss placed in their hair from their mother, Finn crawled under the table to settle on the bench next to Adora, sticking their tongue out at Catra. Catra returned the gesture with a tilted head.

The moment felt strangely like family .

Chapter End Notes

There's more where that came from, folks

Ill probably have the next chapter up within 2 days, so look out for that!

As always comments are my lifeblood, please leave them and kudos if you're liking the story!

family.

Chapter Summary

Park, protective adora, and an unheard confession

Chapter Notes

Iapologize in advance for Catra's actions near the end of the chapter, she made me do it

Ihope everything else makes up for it

See the end of the chapter for more notes

After an hour or so, the trio had finished their lunch. Following goodbyes and another round of fawning over Uncle 'Wrong Hordak' Catra and Adora led Finn out of Bright Moon by holding their hands, the smallest of them in between the two women.

"What's next, kid?" Catra asked Finn as they walked to where she had parked the car. Finn considered it for a moment before answering excitedly.

"I want to take Adora to the park! Adora, let's go to the park!" They exclaimed pulling on both women's hands a bit as they talked. Adora giggled at their antics.

"That sounds like tons of fun! But we have to ask your mom," Adora said, turning to Catra. She put on her best pouty puppy-eyes face and asked in a whiney tone, "Catra...can we please go to the park?"

Catra looked at Adora with fond exasperation. She looked down at Finn, planning to share a 'are you seeing this' look, only to see they had taken on the same expression. Catra rolled her eyes and sighed.

"Stop it with the pouty faces. Y ou know Iwould've said yes anway ," Catre said, shoving Adora's shoulder lightly. The blonde gave a small laugh before tugging Finn along to run the rest of the way to the car.

The sight of the two running of f stirred warmth in Catra's chest. She could get used to the feeling.

~

Adora let herself be dragged by Finn away from the parking lot. Catra followed closely behind and adora could only imagine the fond smile and small shake of her head as she walked. Catra used to do the same thing, drag Adora by the hand yo wherever she was excited about.

Adora spent time climbing the jungle gym with Finn, playing princess and pirate. t really felt just like old times. Once a few other kids showed up, Adora went to sit with Catra on a nearby bench, watching Ginn play with the others.

Adora stretched an arm around the bench behind Catra, and Catra leaned into the gesture. They chatted about their favorite cute moments from the past hour, most notably Finn scrambling to crawl over Adora to beat her getting out of the car.

"Just curious, how did the whole they/them thing come along? Most kids don't figure that out until like highschool," Adora asked. It had been on her mind for a while, but figured it was best to wait until she and Catra were closer.

"Their Auncle Bee. I had them watch Finn a lot when they were in first grade, and Finn just realized they wanted to be called them like their Auncle Bee. Guess they just had a good role model," Catra explained. That actually made a lot of sense. Adora only knew she was gay after she saw her first wlw movie.

"I'm glad they figured it out young. Life would've been so much easier if I knew I was a lesbian then. I could've skipped all of the pretending to have crushes on boys," Adora chuckled. She and Catra were probably the only queer girls in their grade growing up. They knew that by how everyone else thought it was weird to not have a boy they liked.

"Oh man, that was a disaster! Remember when I said I had a crush on that one guy who never talked? Why on earth was that the guy I chose?" Catra laughed. The two women laughed at their memories until they were interrupted by a child crying and Finn rushing to the bench.

"Mama! Adora!" They called as they climbed into Catra's lap, claws pricking where they grabbed on to her shirt.

A short woman with grey hair stalked up to the trio, small child in tow. The child appeared to be crying, or at least upset. The woman, who looked to be their grandmother, looked angry. Oh boy.

"I can't believe they're still letting freaks into neighborhoods like this! Your son is playing dangerously and he is encouraging the other kids to follow him!" She yelled, gesturing wildly as she spoke. The child beside her looked mildly upset, but mainly confused.

Adora rose from her spot beside Catra to defend her kid.

~

Catra always hated this part of parenthood. When bigots and grandmas gave her shit. Not only for her kid being a hybrid, but for the climbing and jumping they did because of it.

Adora standing up to talk to this woman made Catra a little anxious. Was Adora going to apologize and make Finn go home? She always avoided conflict as a kid. Catra was surprised by what came from Adora.

"They're not a freak, they're a kid. Finn did nothing wrong and I will not let your fear-mongering bullcrap keep my kid from being treated fairly," Adora said, voice hard and authoritative. Adora's protective side made Catra's heart warm. And possibly stirred some not very pure thoughts.

"He's going to hurt someone! Not only is he trying to get other kids to do stunts, but he has his claws out! He's going to cut someone! And probably on purpose," the woman continued. Adora rolled her neck and clenched her fists. Oh no.

"They are just playing. They're not hurting anyone and they can play however they'd like. Now leave me and my kid alone, and stop being a racist and transphobic bigot," Adora finished, her voice never wavering. Yep. She just kept getting hotter. Adora gently scooped Finn out of Catra's lap, hiding them close.

"I'm sorry she was being mean to you. I won't let anyone push you around like that," Adora assured, placing a kiss in their hair . Catra heard the rain rumbling of Finn's purr from Adora's arms. The sound made her heart clench painfully. She stood and wrapped around the two of them, assuring both Adora and Finn that everything would be alright.

Adora let Finn down, allowing them to return to playing. Finn smiled up at Adora before bounding away. Adora watched them go with fondness written all over her face.

"You really didn't have to do that," Catra said, sitting back down. Adora sat beside her, this time wrapping her arm around Catra's shoulders.

"But I wanted to. God, I almost had a panic attack though," Adora laughed. Catra shook her head before leaning it on Adora's shoulder. She just couldn't get any more perfect.

~

The three of them ended up spending all of Saturday together . After the park, Catra made Adora and Finn dinner at her apartment before they all watched a movie together. Finn sat between the two women on the couch, eyes wide as they watched the screen. Catra looked to her side to see Adora's head rested on the back of the couch, her eyes closed and breathing heavy.

By the end of the movie, both Finn and Adora had fallen asleep, slightly curled into each other. Catra couldn't help but smile at the intimate moment. She kissed Finn on the head, earning a sleepy flick of their ear.

"Love you baby , sweet dreams," she whispered, laying her head on Adora's shoulder. She angled her head to look at Adora's sleeping face. "I love you too, Adora. Sweet dreams."

No matter how much she tried to fight it, Catra could only describe the three of them as their own family. Almost as if they could read her thoughts, Finn spoke in a sleep-drenched voice.

"I know our family can be just you and me, but can Adora be our family too?"

"Yeah, she can," Catra answered, tucking them in her arms. When the three of them woke the next morning, Finn decided to ask first thing.

"Adora, do you want to be in our family?" They asked, jumping into Adora's lap. She looked at them, eyes pricked with tears, and pulled them in a strong embrace.

"Of course. I'd love to be in your family," she said, voice full of emotion.

Chapter End Notes

eh? EH? sorry not sorry abt the whole co fess when adora cant hear her thing :)

Anyways theres your protective adora and fluffy family moments

Comments and kudos are my lifeblood, leave them if you're enjoying the story!

(Patreon is etherianidiot)

anything for you

Chapter Summary

late-night comfort and the troubles of talking

Chapter Notes

Setup!

Sorry for the long wait, Ive had a lot of mental health issues lately. Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Being part of her own family was nice. Mira's house was home, her family was family, but Adora always felt like a sort of outsider. The feeling lessened as the years went on, but quickly returned after Mira's death. She'd been gone only a year, but Adora already felt her connection to Hope and Razz become less clear.

Having Catra and Finn though, that just felt right. Catra was Adora's only family until age 15, so having her back felt like coming home. And Finn just fit right in their makeshift family, a weird kid for a weird set of orphans.

Soon, the family Finn had invited Adora to be a part of became very real. Over the past months,the three began having dinners together, spending weekends together, and Adora had even stayed the night on occasion. Finn called Adora from their mom's phone often, most of the time just to bring Adora along on a shopping trip with their mom.

Catra left Finn with Adora more often than asked someone to babysit, and Finn much preferred it that way. Finn loved to read stories to Adora, be read them in turn.

And Catra couldn't couldn't have been more wonderful with the change. She allowed and even encouraged Finn's antics. She let them invite Adora along from mundane tasks. And when Finn was away or in bed, things felt just like they did before Adora left.

t was early une, the last day of school. hat meant a half day for students, after which Adora spent the evening at Catra's apartment after she'd finished her work day. Finn lay in bed, a long day of celebration having tired them.

Now, the two women lay in Catra's bed, the tv across from the headboard on but nearly silent. Adora knew Catra could hear it just fine, but she couldn't. She didn't mind though. No tv show could be more comforting than Catra's presence beside her.

Well, not really beside her. Catra was curled into Adora's side, eyes focused on the tv, but her ears were angled towards Adora. She laid her head on Adora's chest, one ear flattened against it. t was just barely noticeable, but Adora felt the subtle vibrations of a purr from the points of contact they shared.

ey , Adora?" Catra spoke unquestioningly . Adora hummed an affirmative, urging Catra to ask what was on her mind. t really means a lot that you're sticking around."

"Of course Im sticking around. Y ou're Catra and Finn, Id do anything for you," Adora replied, leaning her head on Catra's.

"I just mean- ugh. Iwas really hurt when you left. Iblamed you for years and never tried to find you because Ithought you were happier without me," Catra said, her voice shrinking to a whisper by the end of her sentence. Adora's heart stopped as she processed. She took Catra's face in both hands, forcing her to make eye contact.

"Catra, Inever wanted to leave you. Iknow you know that, but Ialso know you needed to hear it. Im happier than ever with you back in my life. Im not staying because Ifeel bad, Im staying because Ilove

you. Both of you,"Adora returned, her voice steady but laced with emotion.

Catra's eyes widened with shock. She looked like she was about to say something, but just burst out of Adora's hold into a strong embrace. Adora felt Catra's heaving chest and tears on her shoulder as the feline cried. Adora simply held her, rubbing soothing lines down her back.

After a few moments, Catra moved her face to the crook of Adora's neck and simply said in a whisper, "Thank you. I love you too."

~

When Catra awoke the next morning, she was pleasantly surprised to find her bed warm, and arm wrapped around her waist. With consciousness returning, she began to purr, not bothering to try and smother it. Last night had been an emotionally taxing night.

Catra had been gearing up to say something to Adora about how she felt like Adora was just sticking around because she felt bad, but never could. Turns out she didn't need to, Adora just knew her too well. One thing did still bother her though.

Adora had said she loved her last night. *I love you, I love you both of you* Catra recalled. Despite Adora's holding Catra's face and declaration of love, nothing else had happened between them. Not besides Adora holding Catra while she cried and falling asleep in each other's arms.

This wasn't how this was supposed to go. Either Catra told Adora and got brutally rejected and thrown out of her life or they declare their love and live happily ever after.

Now though, it seemed like Adora didn't mean it the way she did. Catra would give her life, her soul for Adora. Adora has always been her lifeblood and drive. Maybe to Adora, Catra's just her best friend.

Catra couldn't bring herself to care though, not with Adora in her bed, chest rising and falling with each deep breath under her ear. Not with Adora's heartbeat thrumming in her head, willing her heart with warmth.

Adora stirred, turning her head to the side as she blinked her eyes open. Catra peered up at her, not lifting her head from the blonde's chest. Adora carded a hand through Catra's short mane. Catra slightly butted into Adora's hand, purr kicking up in volume.

Adora gave a small, sleepy laugh, scratching at the base of her ear as she reached it. Catra actually pushed her head into Adora's hand this time, earning her a more hearty laugh. Adora continued her ministrations, gently hiking Catra more on top of her.

The bedroom door opened, a small, furry figure standing in the doorway. Finn gave a yawn, rubbing their eyes.

"Good morning baby ," Catra greeted, looking towards Finn from her spot on Adora's chest. She was just too comfortable to move. Finn sleepily walked towards the bed.

Morning, Mama. Can I join?" They asked, already beginning to climb onto the bedspread. Catra laughed, lifting the edge of the blanket she and Adora shared invitingly. She was about to crack a joke when Adora spoke for her.

"And what do we make this a cat pile?" Adora laughed with a hearty snort. What a dork. "Absolutely . Get in here,"

Finn crawled over Catra's legs with a smile, settling into Adora's other side. The instant the blanket was placed over the kitten, they began to purr, nuzzling into Adora's side, marking her there. Adora gave them a small scratch on the head and tightened her arm around Catra.

~

Adora didn't understand Catra. She'd told the girl she loved her and Catra returned the sentiment, but then nothing. Usually when Adora pictured that moment, it ended in a kiss and living happily ever after.

Even if Catra didn't love her the way Adora did, she was happy for any form of Catra's love. And what more could she want than to lay in Catra's bed with her and her kitten?

The three ate breakfast, oatmeal for Finn and coffee and toast for Catra and Adora. Finn ate quickly, their likeness to Adora amusing.

"Slow down there kid, don't throw up on my table," Catra said sarcastically, taking another bite of her toast. Adora rolled her eyes.

"But if I eat fast, then I get done faster. And if I'm done faster, then I can have fun with you and Adora sooner," they babbled before sticking another funny spoon of oatmeal in their mouth.

"I'm a fast eater and even I don't eat that fast. We have the whole day," Adora giggled.

Finn stopped eating for a moment, squinting at Adora before deliberately shoving a spoonful into their mouth. Catra and Adora burst out in laughter

Chapter End Notes

> Eh? Eh? Can you tell miscommunication is my favorite angst trope?
>
> Anyway
>
> Next chapter is last of story and the one after is an epilogue. Spicy and steamy in both chapters, so look forward to that!
>
> See you later!

clarity

Chapter Summary

THIS CONFESSION HAS BEEN A LONG PROMISED SCENE

Chapter Notes

Im sorry this took so long, writer's block is the worst. ANYWAY, hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

And so the days passed, the small family the three of them had built becoming stronger. Adora spent 3 days a week at Catra's apartment, helping to entertain Finn while she got things done and helping after they'd gone to bed.

Tension and awkwardness ran undercurrent to the domesticity and familiarity of Adora and Catra's relationship. They shared comfortable silence and communicated effortlessly, but when hands brushed or faces got close, someone would turn away, embarrassed and frustrated.

A friday in July rolled around, and with Finn at a friend's house for a sleepover, Adora and Catra had the night to themselves. The two sat on the couch in Catra's apartment, eating takeout from their favorite Chinese restaurant. Adora, leaning on an arm of the couch, is the first to break the slightly uncomfortable silence with a sigh.

"Okay, Im tired of trying to pretend you aren't pulling away. You barely talk to me when Finn's not around and you're always on edge with me. Did I do something?" The blonde asks, setting her plate down on an end table.

Catra tenses at the question. She knew this was coming. Ever since she'd found out Adora doesn't love her the way she loves her, she's been trying to put distance between them.

Maybe if she could avoid getting closer, getting more attached, she could learn to put her love away. Rejection was the last thing she and Finn needed.

"No, you didn't do anything. You're perfect," Catra said with a resigned sigh. Adora huffed at that answer.

"Then why are you being distant? Why are you being so weird? You haven't made a sarcastic comment the whole time I've been here!" Adora exclaimed. She took a deep breath and steeled herself to continue. "It's hard to believe I didn't do anything when the person I know best is acting like someone else."

Tears welled in Catra's eyes, threatening to spill over. Her ears were plastered against the side of her head and her tail curled around her knees.

"I'm sorry, I just- I don't want to get hurt. It just feels like this is too good to be true," Catra replied, resting her head on her knees.

"Catra, I've been here for months, I spend most of my time here. I take care of Finn and love them so much. What is so hard about letting me in your life?" Adora exclaimed, voice raising slightly. Catra suddenly lifted her head to glare at Adora, crying for the first time since that fateful night.

"You really don't get it, do you? I love you! I always have! And I don't need to hear you say you don't love me like that and leave Finn and I alone again," Catra sobbed. Adora sat, jaw hanging, as she proscessed the brunette's words. Catra turned away from her, hiding her face in her knees.

"Love you like that? Catra, I've been trying not to kiss you for months. I love you more than anything, and you and Finn are the

only things Ican't imagine leaving,"Adora explained, causing Catra to gasp. The feline turned around once more, unfurling slowly , to look Adora in the eye.

"You mean that?" The feline asked, voice breaking. Adora simply took her hands and nodded, staring deeply into those familiar eyes. Catra let a sob escape as she rushed to touch Adora. Anything, any comfort. The touch she'd denied herself for so long, apparently for no good reason.

Grasping her face, Catra pushed her lips into Adora's ,the force causing the girl to sway backwards for a moment. After a small epiphany in which Adora realized this was actually happening, the blond kiss ed d back with eqal force. Catra climbed into her lap, straddling her as she continued to press forward.

The two women only parted when they absolutely needed air , pulling back only inches and staring into each other's eyes.

"I love you,"Adora whispered as she moved her hand to caress Catra's side. Catra whimpered at the words, pressing forward for another kiss.

"I love you too,"Catra replied as she pulled away . Adora was the one to surge forward this time, deepening the kiss by licking into Catra's mouth. She groaned as she ran her tongue along the edge of the girl's fangs, pulling a soft moan from the feline's lips.

Adora's grip on Catra's hip tightened instinctively at the sound, causing Catra to pull away, breathless.

"I don't know what you're ready for but I've wanted to do this for so long. Bedroom?" She asked, an anxious edge to her voice. Adora gasped at the implications, nodding eagerly. Catra laughed at the response.

Catra's laughter continued as Adora carried her, legs wrapped around the blonde's waist, to her bedroom. Adora dropped her on

the bed with less grace than intended and climbed over Catra to hover above her face once again.

Catra pulled Adora down by the neck into a bruising kiss. They both groaned into the kiss, their bodies ache for each other finally being quenched. As Catra took control of the kiss, she pushed Adora up to a sitting position, straddling her lap once again.

She trailed kisses from the corner of Adora's mouth, all the way to her jawline, running her tongue along the curve of the jawline she'd admired for so long. Adora's breath hitched at the movement, arching her back into Catra.

The brunette slid her hands under the hem of Adora's shirt, reveling in the feeling of soft skin and taught muscles under her fingertips. Adora moaned softly, arching further into Catra's hands.

"Off?" Catra questioned, tugging on the end of Adora's shirt. The blonde whispered a breathless *yes* and Catra lost all self-control. She ripped the shirt off over her lover's head, pausing for a moment to admire the soft curves and defined muscles of Adora's exposed stomach.

Adora covered her face with her hands when she noticed Catra staring, cheeks flushing an even darker red. Catra dragged the girl's hands away by her wrists, leaning back into her space.

"Beautiful," Catra whispered before pressing in for a bruising kiss. Both women groaned into the kiss and Adora's hands slipped under Catra's shirt in silent request. Catra chuckled as she pulled away, as if she could deny Adora anything.

Adora was once again speechless when Catra's shit came off, revealing no bra underneath. That fact about her friend was the bane of teenage Adora's existence.

Catra looked into the blonde's eyes expectantly as if seeking some sort of approval. Her ears were set flat against her head and her tail

lashed behind her in nervousness. In lieu of words, Adora simply groaned and pushed in for another kiss.

She ran her hands up the feline's sides, landing just below her breasts. Catra moaned into the kiss, pressing up into Adora's hands. Understanding the message, Adora began to explore the curve of the girl's chest.

Catra broke away from the kiss, breathing heavily, and ducked her head to the base of Adora's neck. Adora hummed at the motion, content with reducing Catra to this mess.

The blonde was surprised though when she felt claws gently skating up her sides and slithering under the band of her sports bra. Catra pulled the band away by half an inch before letting it snap back into the girl's skin. Adora gasped at the motion, breaking their kiss, and Catra took the opportunity to begin taking the offending garment off. When Adora caught up, she lifted the stretchy material over her head and threw it unceremoniously behind her. Catra gave a small chuckle at that before moving in to rest her head on Adora's shoulder.

Catra then skated her hands up Adora's muscular abdomen to knead at her breasts. Adora groaned, first at the sensuality and then at the motion of Catra's thumbs over her nipples. Adora let her head fall back, baring her neck to Catra. Taking the opportunity, Catra sucked a dark mark into the delicate skin. She earned a throaty groan at that.

The feline continued to tease the blonde with light touches and possessive kisses for what seemed like an eternity. Eventually, Adora carded her fingers through Catra's hair and tugged her up to meet her eyes. Catra moaned quietly at the sensation.

"Hey Catra?" Adora breathlessly asked her lover. Catra made a questioning sound in response, her eyes staring into blue ones intently. "I love you."

Catra felt muscles tense beneath her and the next thing she knew, she was laying down on her bed, vision of the bedroom obscured by a curtain of blonde hair. Catra moaned as she felt Adora suck a matching mark to the many she already held into the side of her neck.

"Again," the brunette pleaded desperately , arching her back into Adora's hands creeping up her chest.

"I love you," Adora repeated before dragging Catra in a searing kiss. It was far from skilled, passion, teeth, and gasping breath making that hard, but it was the best Catra had ever had.

As the blonde pulled back just an inch to look her lover in the eyes, she whispered a breathless promise.

"I love you so much. I'm going to take care of you for the rest of your life. I'll never leave you behind again."

Her voice cracked with emotion and tears welled up in her eyes, threatening to spill. Catra cupped the girl's cheeks and gently wiped away the forming tears. She pulled Adora in for a chaste kiss before setting their foreheads together.

"I love you too. I'll stop hiding," she responded. A bit too emotional to be sensual, but the words sparked a glowing warmth in Adora's chest.

Bracing herself on one arm, the blonde cupped Catra's cheek and tilted her chin upward. Catra whined and promptly closed the small gap between their lips. Catra's hands rose from the sheets and continued their earlier exploration.

Adora stayed for only a moment longer before inching down Catra's body, reaching her collarbones before looking up at her through fluttering eyelids. Catra couldn't see the look, however, as her head was thrown back in a mix of eqal measures pleasure and

frustration. The feline gave a whine, arching her chest up into Adora's, encouraging her to continue.

Adora placed a light kiss on Catra's collar bones before descending lower on her lover's body. The sensation of Adora's hands gently skating up her sides was replaced with them cupping a tit in each hand, rolling thumb over both nipples.

Catra moaned and immediately turned her head away in embarrassment. Adora pulled one hand away to reposition Catra's head.

"Don't be embarrassed, I love hearing you," Adora commented, her voice low and gravely, before wrapping her lips around Catra's right nippple. The blonde ran her tongue over the hardened bud, causing Catra to cry out.

"*Please,*" Catra whined. Adora lifted her head from Catra's chest to look her in the eye as she trailed a hand down the girl's abdomen.

"Please? Please what?" Adora teased, slipping her fingers beneath Catra's waistband. Catra growled, carnal and low, before shoving her leggings and underwear down her thighs in one swift moment.

Adora gasped at her love's desperation, surprised to have reduced Catra to this mess in just a few minutes. At the smell of Catra's wetness hitting the air and Catra arching her pelvis this time into Adora's hands, she lost all self control.

The blonde pulled off the leggings violently, Catra whining at the loss of touch. Eager to feel Catra against all of her, Adora quickly threw off her lounge pants and sent them to lay forgotten on the floor with the rest of their clothes.

Adora returned her hand to Catra, resting them on the insides of the women's thighs. She stroked up and down the slackened skin for a moment as Catra made eye contact. Her blue and amber eyes were darkened with lust and had an edge of desperation to them.

Adora surged forward to take Catra's mouth in a fiery kiss at the same moment she slid a hand up to meet Catra's center. Two fingers slid through the damp folds, avoiding her clit purposefully.

Catra cried out into the kiss, turning her head to pant. Adora rested her head on Catra's shoulder to watch her hand disappear beneath the apex of Catra's legs.

"Adora," Catra whined, pausing to let out a soft *ah* as Adora grazed gently by her clit. "Stop teasing. *Fuckme,* "

Adora let out a possessive growl at the pleading in Catra's tone. She rubbed light circles around her lover's clit, increasing pressure ever so slightly until she found the one that turned every third breath to a low moan.

Catra clung to Adora's back, the beginnings of claws pricking the pale skin. Adora found the pain intoxicating, pinpoints enough to draw even more heat to pool low in her abdomen.

Catra began a low chant of *ah* s, small curses, and *Adora.* t was broken by a whimper, and a broken whisper.

"Inside. W ant you," Catra muttered, almost nonsensically . Adora groaned at the plea, leaving her left hand to circle the girl's clit as she prepared to insert a finger into Catra's entrance.

t slid in ef fortlessly, wet head enveloping the digit and clutching to it as if to keep it in. Catra's moans rose in pitch and she threw an arm over her eyes. A moment passed of gentle thrusting and adjustment before Catra whimpered again.

"Another , *Pease Adora,* "she whispered. Adora immediately complied, eager to please her lover. Catra's walls tightened around the intrusion before relaxing at Adora's encouragement.

"That's it, just relax for me. Y ou're doing so well for me. So beautiful," Adora assured her, causing Catra to release an embarrassingly loud

moan.

"You like that? To be told how good you are?" Adora asked, a teasing lilt to her voice.

"Shut up," Catra replied, pressing the side of her face further into the mattress.

"I don't think you want me to, beautiful," Adora said, voice sultry and almost condescending. Catra's irritation quickly fell away as the blonde continued.

"So pretty, and all *mine*. Fuck, I love you so much. You're doing so well for me. Just like that," Adora continued, adding more power to her thrusts. Catra cried out at the praise, lifting a thigh to press against Adora's center.

The woman gave a moan at the sensation, immediately beginning to grind down into the lean surface. The two found a rhythm in their pleasure, riding a conjoined high as sweat poured off their bodies.

Catra's moans began to rise in pich faster. She opened her eyes to look into Adora's grey-blue ones as her jaw went slack with pleasure.

"I'm gonna- *ah* - I'm gonna cu-" Catra is cut off by a particularly strong thrust, turning the last syllable into a small cry.

"Come for me, baby. Let me take care of you," Adora replied, leaning her forehead against Catra's. The two held eye contact for a few moments before Catra's eyes screwed closed with overwhelming pleasure.

"Open your eyes, I want to see you when you come," Adora ordered. Catra opened them obediently, crying out at the demanding tone of Adora's voice. Adora watched her lover's eyes cloud with lust as her walls tightened around her fingers.

"It's ok, there you go. I love you. Y ou did so well," Adora assured the feline, lightening the pressure on her clit as she worked the girl through her orgasm. When Catra came to, Adora had curled her against her chest, soft skin now sticky with sweat. Catra's purr, which she hadn't noticed until this moment, kicked up to full volume, creating a rumble that Adora could feel in her own chest.

Adora softly pet Catra's hair as she cradled her close. "Y ou ok?" She asks, like the perfect lover she is. Catra nods wordlessly into the blonde's sternum.

"I love you," Catra whispers into the supple skin, voice rough from use.

"I love you too," Adora replied gently , smile evident in her voice. They lay like that for a few moments before Catra lifted her head to look at Adora's face.

"Y ou want a turn?" She asked, smirk set on her face despite the utter exhaustion and contentment in her expression.

"Another time, love. Rest up, you look exhausted," Adora replied, tucking Catra under her chin. Catra rolled her eyes, but sunk into her lover's embrace.

"Fine, as long as I get to fuck you when I get up," catra surrendered with a sigh. Adora gave a small chuckle, pressing a kiss into Catra's hair.

"I would love nothing more," Adora replied.

When Catra fell asleep that night, she was enveloped in the warmth and softness of the woman she'd loved since before she knew what love meant. All felt right with the world, everything as it should be. Finn would complete the peace later, now all Catra wanted was the press of her and Adora's bare bodies in the still night.

For once, Catra didn't feel empty. She felt whole, at peace. She would get her promise fulfilled tomorrow morning, but also every morning after.

Catra had her whole future to look forward to, with the love of her life and the kid of her dreams. Things might not have turned out how she imagined, but no fantasy could be better than this.

Chapter End Notes

Sooooo..... good?
Our last chapter is an epilogue, and I have yet to finish it so you get to decide. Do you guys want smut in the epilogue? Cuz, I'm thinking smut in the epilogue.

As always comments and kudos are appreciated, thank you for sticking with me through this story!

epilogue (happy endings)

Chapter Summary

here it is, the long awaited epilogue

lovers, a question, and some very fluffy smut

Chapter Notes

In honor of Catra's birthday , this story is finally coming to a close

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora awoke to the sound of chirping birds and a rumbling purr from the lithe form draped over her. The bird's cheerful tone and bright melody matched the lightness of Adora's heart in that moment.

She had woken up this way many times before. First, as small children. Hiding away from the terrors of their foster mother and the rest of the cruel world. Then, as teenagers. Fumbling awkwardly through unspoken feelings and budding romance. And more recently, when Adora fell asleep in Catra's bed after a late night with her and Finn.

Today was different though. Not only was her heart light and body relaxed, but her mind reeled with the events of last night. She'd confessed it all after Catra revealed her feelings. They'd loved like she wished they could've since she was a teenager. And now she enjoys the gentle slide of thin fur on her skin as Catra's chest rises and falls with each deep breath.

~

1 year later

"Please be good for your aunts," Adora reminded as she took the kit from their car seat.

"Yeah, I know. I'm always good," Finn replied as they began walking to Scorpia and Perfuma's door. They'd be watching Finn tonight, Catra insisted they have a real date night this Friday. It had been a while, Adora supposed. The couple opened the door and Finn rushed inside to greet the cat just inside the door.

"Thank you two so much," Adora said, motioning for Finn to come back and say goodbye.

"No problem, they're our favorite nibling," Scorpia dismissed. Adora rolled her eyes, she always said that despite the fact Finn was their only nibling.

"Bye Finn, come give me a hug," Adora prompted, causing them to run towards her giggling. She pulled them to her side and dropped a kiss in their head. "Love you buddy, be good."

"I will. Bye Mommy, love you!" they said before running back into their aunt's house. Adora smiled as she watched them go. No matter how many times they'd said it, Finn calling her *mommy* still makes Adora's heart melt.

~

"Are you going to tell me where we're going?" Adora questioned from the passenger seat. She and Catra had dressed up for their night alone, and Catra was driving them to some secret location.

"I told you, princess, it's a surprise," Catra smirked, knowing just how much the suspense was killing her. Adora rolled her eyes and punched Catra's arm lightly. Catra chuckled as she made the next turn. Adora has some semblance of an idea of course, there was a cheesy and unbearably cute picnic basket placed in the trunk. Catra would only be such a cliché romantic with Adora.

Adora recognized the neighborhood as they passed, the slightly dilapidated buildings and streets of their first home, the Fright Zone. Really, the town was called Frighton but no one who lived there pretended it was nicer than it was.

Catra pulled their car into the familiar gravel parking lot of the park just half a mile away from their foster mother's home.

"We're here," She announced as she took the key out of the ignition, as if Adora couldn't tell.

"Here? This is quite the throwback," Adora commented, unbuckling her seatbelt. Catra chuckled, stepping out of the car. Adora came out to see Catra already opening the trunk and fetching the basket she'd packed.

"Would you mind carrying this for me, princess?" Catra asked, gesturing to the blanket that had made the trunk its permanent home.

"Only because you asked so nicely," Adora giggled, leaning over Catra to grab it. She planted a kiss on Catra's cheek as she pulled away. The two of them had always been affectionate, confessing their feelings for each other only brought this out. As much as Catra is still pleasantly surprised when Adora shows small forms of affection, it is slowly becoming worn and familiar.

Catra set up their small picnic, laying out the blanket and setting out the food and cutlery she'd brought. Adora blushed at being pampered and doted on as Catra helped her lower down onto the blanket, placing a kiss in her hair once she was seated.

Catra sat beside her, leaning on the blonde's shoulder. They talked about their weeks, the drama at work and Finn's latest antics. They fought with their forks as they ate, like they were kids again.

"I still get heart palpitations when they call me mommy," Adora said wistfully, resting her cheek on Catra's head. Catra smiled softly.

"Let' s hope those dont get too bad, they say that almost every time they talk to you, we dont want you having a heart attack," Catra remarked, using the soft tone she spoke with when she teased.

"ha , har. Ijust, really love when they show they love me just as much as Ilove them," Adora finished. Catra turned her head slightly to drop a light kiss on Adora's collarbone. Adora hummed softly, pulling Catra's head out of her neck with a soft finger under her chin. Catra let out the most *adorable* mrrp at the gesture. Adora pulled her in for a chaste kiss, lingering in her space for a moment with a smile on her lips.

"I love you," Catra whispered, tilting her head to touch their foreheads together. Adora smiled wider.

"I love you too," She returned, caressing the brunette' s cheek. Catra took a deep, shaky breath before pulling away to stand. She reached a hand down to help Adora up, the blonde looking at her with a questioning look.

Adora could feel the tension in Catra's body just through their point of contact at their hands, and became nervous. What was she planning?

~

Catra had been planning this for months. Really, since Adora'd first held her as she cried all those months ago. Catra mentally prepared herself for the scariest thing she'd ever done, reporting her abusive foster mother included.

Falling to one knee, Catra fished a small, black, velvet box from the pocket of the suit jacket. Adora went completely still, eyes wide and breathing short. Catra smirked at her reaction before becoming just as nervous as before.

"I dont remember a time when Ididn't love you. At age 1 1, Iwas already planning our wedding and making blueprints for our house.

You saved me when the world was breaking me down, when Weaver was being a racist, homophobic bitch," Catra began. Adora cut her off with a watery snort at that last comment. "You found me after all this time, and despite the decade between us, welcomed me back. You took my baby, my life, and treated them with care and kindness. You've become a wonderful mother and an amazing girlfriend," she said.

Catra paused, taking a deep breath as Adora's eyes shone with tears.

"I want to spend the rest of my life with you. Adora *Rainbow* Grayskull, will you marry me?" Catra finished, a bit breathless with anticipation. Adora let out a sob, falling to her knees in front of Catra. The blonde pulled her in, sealing their mouths in a loving kiss.

"Yes, yes, yes, yes, yes," she exclaimed, tears streaming down her face. "God, yes."

Catra also began to cry as she opened the small box, pulling out the ring she'd selected. It was a thin, gold band with a mid-sized sapphire. Small diamonds lay in the band on either side, helping the bright blue stone stand out.

Adora wiped her tears with the back of her right hand, offering her left to her *fiancee.* Catra look it shakily, sliding the delicate jewelry on her ring finger. It fit perfectly, sitting snugly on her pale skin. Adora lifted the rind to the sun, admiring the way the sapphire shimmered in the light. She broke down into sobs again, burying her face in Catra's shoulder.

Catra gave a watery laugh as she held Adora close. Adora cried tears of ecstatic joy for a few minutes more before lifting her head and dragging Catra into a searing kiss. It might've been a bit intense for public, but no one was around. Besides, they'd just gotten engaged, who could judge?

~

As much as Adora had tried to wait out the evening and appreciate all the work that went into this picnic, Catra kept sending her heated glances over her glass of wine. Catra had put the cork back in the bottle with a grin. *Shall we take this home?*

Catra drove them home, to the apartment they'd shared for 9 months. One hand on the wheel and the other possessively gripping Adora's thigh, Adora was ecstatic and living on cloud nine.

Part of it was definitely the promise of the rest of tonight, but mostly it was because Adora could feel the gold ring on her finger, a reminder of the promise of forever.

Adora held the sapphire gem of her ring to the light of the setting sun. Catra removed her hand to turn onto their street, returning it within seconds. This time bringing it much higher up, her pinkie just millimeters from the apex of Adora's thighs.

Adora gasped quietly and she saw a sly smirk settle onto Catra's lips. God, those lips.

Catra turned into a spot in their building's parking lot, a tad more aggressive than necessary. Adora giggles and Catra growls slowly. That shuts the blonde up. They both rush to open their doors and Catra drags her *fiancee* by the hand to their apartment.

The moment the front door closes behind them, Adora finds herself pinned against it, Catra already pressing in for a bruising kiss. The blonde moaned into the kiss, bringing her hands to rest on the feline's hips.

Adora guides them blindly towards their bedroom, fumbling with the doorknob as Catra refuses to part. The door opens and Catra trails kisses across Adora's face, to her jaw.

Adora leans her head back, allowing her lover ample access to the expanse of her neck. Walking Catra back, the brunette's knees hit

the edge of the bed, causing her to fall back onto the soft surface. Adora hovered over her, weight resting on her forearms.

Adora grabs Catra's jaw, positioning her head to match the marks forming on her own neck. She slits a muscular thigh between Catra's own, and Catra immediately rolls her hips to create even the slightest release for her aching core.

Catra slides her hands under Adora's dress, resting her hands on the tops of her thighs. Adora moans into her neck, sound muffled by the skin she is currently sucking on.

At the sound, Catra swiftly moves her hands to feel for the zipper on Adora's back. Pulling it slowly, the chest of the red dress becomes loose and exposed the tops of Adora's breasts. Adora pulls her arms back to let the dress fall from her shoulders, and to the floor.

Catra growls a bit as she takes her claws down Adora's back gently, not nearly enough to scratch. Adora moans into the kiss, she'd always been one for a little pain.

Catra grabs Adora's face and pulls it away from her neck to look her in the eye.

"Come on, princess. Help me out of these," she says in a gravely whisper. Adora shudders and immediately begins to swiftly unbutton Catra's shirt. She watches as every inch of tan skin and thin fur is exposed.

Once Catra's shirt is completely open, she guides Adora's hands to the button of her slacks. With increasingly shaking hands, she undoes and pulls down Catra's pants. She kneels to pull them off her feet, then settles there. She looks at her *fiancee* with lidded eyes and an easy smile. Catra ran a hand through her blonde hair, taking out Adora's signature ponytail.

She then proceeded to massage the blonde's scalp, letting her hair fall evenly over her shoulders. Catra leaned down to press a gentle

kiss to her lover's lips, which she accepted with a happy sigh.

"I love you," Catra said, voice soft and affectionate. Adora hummed happily and leaned into the hand in her hair. "My pretty girl."

Adora gave a breathy moan at the praise, shifting on her knees a little. Catra's smile turns into more of a smirk as she tightens her grip on Adora's hair. The girl gasps at the pressure.

"I want you to eat me out so I can cum in your pretty mouth. Then, I want to fuck you while you wear nothing but my ring. Do you want that?" Catra asked, sincerity joining her teasing tone. Adora nodded jerkily, gasping at her exit suggestion.

Catra shook her head before pulling Adora's hair upwards. Adora whined at the manhandling, closing her eyes.

"Use your words, princess. Look in my eyes and tell me you want it," Catra instructed. Adora opened her eyes, her gaze was hazy and filled with desire.

"Yes, I want it," Adora said breathily.

"You want what?" Catra prompted. She wasn't going to get away with being vague tonight. The blonde took a shaky deep breath before continuing.

"I want you to cum in my mouth and fuck me in nothing but your ring," Adora conceded. Catra's grin turned predatory at the admission.

Reaching behind her, Catra undid the clasp of her bra, letting it fall from her arms onto the floor. She then lifted her hips in blatant instruction.

Adora hurried to grab hold of the band of her underwear and pull it off. Catra stroked through Adira's hair once more before gripping it by the roots and pushing towards the apex of her thighs.

Adora looked up at Catra once more before leaning in to lick a long stripe up the length of her. Catra hissed in pleasure at this first stroke.

Adora moved in the way she had practiced so many times in the past year, hitting every sensitive spot. Reeling back when needed and pressing in after. Catra never relinquished her tight hold on her hair, but the pull on her scalp and the feeling of Catra holding her face close never bothered her. The obscene sounds of endless moans and their bodies moving together filled the room, a symphony to Catra's sensitive ears.

Catra's hips began to move erratically, jerky movements signaling that she was close. Adora looked towards her face just in time to make eye contact with her lover, pushing her over the edge.

"Yes! Oh good girl! Fuck!" Catra cried as she thrust her hips into Adora's mouth. Adora stilled her tongue, letting Catra ride out her high to its end. Catra's head tipped back, showcasing the slender muscles of her chest and neck. She truly was a vision.

Catra's hips stilled and she ran her hands through Adora's hair while she caught her breath. After a moment, she lifted Adora's chin to look at her face. Adora let herself be led with pleasure.

"Always so perfect for me, my beautiful girl," Catra cooed. Adora smiled and hummed her affirmation. "Come stand up for me." She instructed, careful of Adora's knees having been on the floor.

Adora stood up with shaky legs and protesting knees. Catra held her close and moaned as she tasted herself on Adora's lips when she kissed her.

Catra slowly spun them around until Adora fell back against the bed. Catra kissed her passionately as she crawled up her body. Slipping a thigh between Adora's she trailed kissed down her fiancee's neck.

"I love you," she whispered, just because she could. Adora smiled softly.

"I love you too," she answered. Slowly , and while tracing every curve with her hands, Catra helped Adora out of her bra and underwear, leaving just their bare bodies in the night.

As promised, her new engagement ring stayed on. Catra lifted her girl's left hand to her mouth, delicately placing kisses on each fingertip. Adora giggled at the tenderness.

"Y ou ready?" Catra asked, stroking a thumb over Adora's hip bone. Adora nodded weakly, eyes open and full of hazy desire. Catra left her with one last chaste kiss, extricating herself from Adora's grasp. Adora whined at the loss.

"I know baby , I'm just getting your favorite toy and I'll be right back," Catra assured her, pleased at the now pleasured answering whine.

Catra returned with Adora's favorite strap secured to her hips with a leather harness. t had thick, black straps and attached garter belts. Adora moaned at the sight as Catra crawled back on top of her.

Catra drew light circles on Adora's clit, smug about just how wet her lover was after pleasuring her. She pressed the tip of the toy to her entrance, but spent a few more moments paying attention to her clit to warm her up. Afora threw her head back, moaning at the stimulation. After some time, Adora gave a frustrated whine and pulled her head up to look at Catra.

"Come on baby , fuck me. Please," she pleaded, reaching for Catra's wrist at her waist. "Please, Catra," she whined.

Catra pressed a kiss to the top of her nose before serving their foreheads together.

"Of course princess."

Catra set a slow pace as she eased the toy into Adora, who took each inch with pleasured enthusiasm. Once Adora had given a nod to signal she was ready for more, Catra thrusted with more force, only speeding up slightly.

She continued to ramp up speed and power as Adora begged for it with cries of *more* and *f aster!* She felt her love bearing her peak, so she gently applied more pressure to her clit, rubbing in a pattern she knew well. Adora's moans increased in pitch as her brows drew together and her back arched.

"Let go baby , Im here. Come for me," Catra encouraged and Adora's muscles tightened. Adora came with a gasp and a silent scream. Catra worked her through it gently, slowing her pace and providing assurances of *good girl, thats right, so good f or me.* Adora came to herself with a content look on her face, dragging Catra down into a languid kiss.

They'd have to get up to clean up and bathe, but for now it's just them, without a care in the world. Catra carefully removes the harness form herself setting it on the bed somewhere. She holds Adora close as the bathe in the afterglow, sharing chaste kisses and murmured assurances.

"Hey Catra?" Adora asked, her voice content and floaty .

"What's that?"

"Im gonna marry you," she responded, nuzzling the side of Catra's neck. She gave a giggle. Yeah, her fiancee was such a dork. And she loved it.

"I love you," Catra answered, placing a kiss on Adora's temple. Adora smiled into her lover's neck.

"I love you too."

Chapter End Notes

Ijust want to thank all of my readers who have been supporting me whole Iwrote this. Ive definitely grown as an author and I have all of you to thank for that.

Ipromised smut, and now you have 1k words of it, you're welcome

Ihope you enjoyed this story , and Im glad to see you've stuck it through. Ill have more coming soon and Ilook forward to seeing you all again.

Bye!

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!